

# Global Expense Policy 2024

Document ID D01 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2024-12-31 · Category general

## GEP24-1.1 - Purpose and scope

This policy governs reimbursement of business expenses incurred by employees of Northstar Analytics Group and its subsidiaries for transactions dated between 1 January 2024 and 31 December 2024. Transactions dated in another calendar year are governed by the policy version published for that year.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the temporal scope of the reimbursement policy, ensuring that employees understand which transactions are eligible for reimbursement based on the specified calendar year. This is crucial for maintaining clarity and consistency in the application of the policy across the organization. Typical business situations covered by this clause include travel expenses, office supplies, and other business-related expenditures incurred during the designated period. By clearly establishing the timeframe, the policy aids in the effective management of financial resources and ensures compliance with fiscal regulations.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause may arise from employees assuming that expenses incurred outside the specified calendar year are automatically eligible for reimbursement. It is essential to clarify that only transactions dated within the defined period are governed by this policy, while others must adhere to the version applicable to their respective years. This clause is conceptually linked to the overall expense management framework, as it sets the foundation for the validity of subsequent claims and reinforces the importance of adhering to established timelines in the reimbursement process.

## GEP24-1.2 - Business purpose

Every expense must have a clear business purpose connected to company activity. Personal benefit alone is not reimbursable.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause emphasizes the necessity for a clear business purpose associated with each expense incurred by employees. The primary aim is to ensure that all reimbursements are directly tied to activities that benefit the company, thereby safeguarding corporate resources and promoting responsible spending. Typical business situations covered under this clause include travel for client meetings, expenses for professional development, and costs associated with business-related events. By requiring a clear business purpose, the policy fosters a culture of accountability and aligns employee expenditures with the company's strategic objectives.

A frequent misconception about this clause is the belief that any expense can be justified as long as it is vaguely related to business activities. However, the policy explicitly states that personal benefits alone do not qualify for reimbursement, which underscores the need for a direct connection to company activities. This clause relates closely to the documentation requirements outlined in the subsequent policy sections, as a well-defined business purpose must be supported by adequate documentation to ensure compliance and facilitate the approval process.

## GEP24-1.3 - Documentation

A claim must state the merchant, transaction date, currency, total amount and a description sufficient to determine the business purpose. Category policies may require additional fields; where a required field is absent the claim cannot be approved.

**Interpretive guidance.** The intent of this clause is to establish clear guidelines regarding the documentation required for expense claims. By specifying the necessary details, such as the merchant, transaction date, currency, total amount, and a description of the business purpose, this clause aims to streamline the reimbursement process and ensure that claims are transparent and verifiable. Typical business situations that this clause addresses include employees submitting claims for travel expenses, office supplies, or any other business-related purchases. The requirement for comprehensive documentation serves to protect both the employee and the organization by minimizing the risk of errors and facilitating timely reimbursements.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that minimal documentation suffices for claim approval. The policy clearly states that a claim lacking any required field cannot be approved, which highlights the importance of thoroughness in documentation. This clause is closely related to the submission window and late submission policies, as timely and complete documentation is essential for ensuring that claims are submitted within the established timeframe and can be processed without delay.

### **GEP24-2.1 - Submission window**

Claims must be submitted within 60 calendar days of the transaction date. A claim submitted later is rejected unless an approved exception exists.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to establish a clear timeline for the submission of expense claims, ensuring that employees are aware of the expectations regarding the timely reporting of expenses. By mandating that claims be submitted within a specified timeframe following the transaction date, the policy aims to promote efficiency in the reimbursement process and facilitate accurate financial reporting. Typical business situations covered by this clause include employees submitting claims for travel expenses or other business-related costs incurred during work-related activities. Adhering to the submission window is crucial for maintaining effective financial management and accountability within the organization.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that claims can be submitted at any time without consequence. Employees may not realize that late submissions are subject to rejection unless an approved exception exists. This clause is conceptually linked to the late submission and outage relief policies, as both emphasize the importance of timely submissions and outline the implications of failing to meet the established deadlines. Understanding these interconnections is vital for employees to navigate the reimbursement process effectively.

### **GEP24-2.2 - Late submission and outage relief**

Late submission tiers are counted in calendar days from the transaction date to the submission date. Formally recorded Finance system outage relief is published by circular and applies only to transactions dated inside the stated outage window.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the implications of late submissions of expense claims and provides a framework for understanding the consequences of not adhering to the established submission window. By outlining that late submissions are counted in calendar days and may be rejected unless an approved exception exists, the policy aims to encourage timely reporting and accountability among employees. Typical business situations covered include instances where employees may forget to submit claims or encounter unforeseen delays. This clause reinforces the importance of adhering to deadlines to ensure smooth reimbursement processes and accurate financial tracking.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the assumption that all late submissions will be automatically accepted or reviewed without consequence. Employees may not fully grasp that only claims submitted within the specified timeframe are eligible for consideration, and that exceptions are not guaranteed. This clause is conceptually related to the submission window policy, as both emphasize the significance of timely submissions and the potential ramifications of delays. Understanding these interrelated policies is essential for employees to navigate the reimbursement landscape effectively.

### **GEP24-2.3 - Currency**

Thresholds expressed in SGD equivalent are tested as set out in the Currency and FX Handling Policy. Ceilings expressed in a local currency are tested in that currency without conversion.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify how currency thresholds are assessed within the context of the reimbursement policy. By specifying that thresholds expressed in a certain currency are tested according to the guidelines set out in the Currency and FX Handling Policy, the clause aims to ensure consistency and accuracy in the evaluation of claims. Typical business situations covered include employees submitting claims for expenses incurred in various currencies, such as international travel or purchases made abroad. The clear delineation of currency handling helps to mitigate confusion and ensures that all claims are processed fairly and uniformly.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause may arise from employees assuming that all currency conversions are automatically applied to claims. It is important to clarify that ceilings expressed in a local currency are tested in that currency without conversion, which can lead to discrepancies if not properly understood. This clause is conceptually linked to the broader financial management policies, as it emphasizes the importance of accurate currency handling in the reimbursement process and aligns with the organization's commitment to financial integrity.

### **GEP24-3.1 - Order of precedence**

Where rules differ, the order of precedence is: law and regulation; the applicable regional addendum; a Finance circular from its effective date, which amends the clause it names; an approved written exception

within its stated scope; the category policy; this global policy; and finally definitions, frequently asked questions and worked examples, which never override the clauses above.

**Interpretive guidance.** The order of precedence clause establishes a clear hierarchy for resolving conflicts among various rules and guidelines governing corporate expenses. This clause is particularly relevant in situations where multiple policies might apply to a single transaction or expense claim. By delineating the order in which these rules should be considered, it ensures that employees and reviewers have a consistent framework to follow, thereby promoting compliance with legal and regulatory requirements as well as internal policies. This clarity helps to streamline decision-making processes and minimizes confusion in the administration of expense claims.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the interpretation of specific policies and how they interact with one another. Employees might assume that all policies hold equal weight, leading to potential conflicts in expense claims. It is essential to recognize that this clause is conceptually linked to other policy topics such as the applicability of circulars and the treatment of exceptions. Understanding the order of precedence helps clarify how to approach situations where multiple rules apply, ensuring that employees adhere to the most authoritative guidelines.

### **GEP24-3.2 - Circulars**

A Finance circular amends the clause it names from its effective date only. A transaction dated before the effective date is decided under the value that applied on its own transaction date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The circulars clause clarifies the temporal applicability of Finance circulars in relation to the expense policy. This provision is particularly significant when there are changes or updates to existing clauses, as it ensures that any amendments take effect only from the specified date of the circular. This promotes transparency and fairness in the application of rules, as it allows employees to understand which version of the policy applies to their transactions based on the date they occurred. This clause is essential in maintaining the integrity of the expense review process and ensuring compliance with updated standards.

A common misconception regarding this clause is the belief that circulars can retroactively alter the conditions of transactions that occurred prior to their effective date. This misunderstanding can lead to confusion among employees about which rules apply to their claims. This topic is closely related to the order of precedence, as understanding how circulars amend existing clauses helps clarify the hierarchy of rules. Employees should be aware that while circulars provide important updates, they do not change the rules governing transactions that have already occurred.

### **GEP24-4.1 - Insufficient evidence**

If a mandatory fact cannot be determined from the claim or from approved enterprise records, the reviewer requests the missing information from the employee. Facts must not be inferred from the employee narrative when an authoritative record exists.

**Interpretive guidance.** The insufficient evidence clause is designed to ensure that all claims submitted for reimbursement are supported by adequate documentation. This provision is particularly relevant in situations where the necessary information to substantiate a claim is missing or unclear. By mandating that reviewers request additional information from employees when required, the clause reinforces the importance of maintaining accurate and reliable records. This process not only protects the integrity of the expense review system but also ensures that employees are held accountable for providing comprehensive evidence to support their claims.

A frequent misunderstanding of this clause is the assumption that reviewers can make inferences based on the employee's narrative when authoritative records are available. This can lead to inconsistencies in the evaluation of claims and potentially result in improper reimbursements. This topic is conceptually linked to the human review clause, as both emphasize the importance of clear documentation and the role of reviewers in ensuring compliance with policy requirements. Understanding the necessity of authoritative evidence helps employees appreciate the rationale behind thorough documentation.

### **GEP24-4.2 - Human review**

A claim is escalated to Finance where two rules conflict and precedence cannot be determined from published text, where an approval conflicts with the transaction facts, or where the amount exceeds the Finance review threshold in the Approval Authority Policy.

**Interpretive guidance.** The human review clause establishes a protocol for escalating claims that present conflicts or uncertainties in the application of the expense policy. This is particularly crucial in situations where there is ambiguity in the interpretation of rules or discrepancies between approvals and transaction facts. By outlining the circumstances under which a claim should be escalated to Finance, this clause ensures that complex cases receive the appropriate level of scrutiny and that decisions are made in accordance with established guidelines, thereby enhancing the overall integrity of the expense management process.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding what constitutes a conflict warranting escalation. Employees might not fully grasp the nuances of the policy, leading them to believe that any disagreement or uncertainty necessitates a review. This clause is conceptually related to the insufficient evidence clause, as both emphasize the importance of clarity and accuracy in expense claims. Understanding when to escalate a claim helps employees navigate the review process more effectively and ensures compliance with the overarching policy framework.

### **GEP24-5.1 - Applicability by date**

This policy version applies only to transactions dated in 2024. A later version does not apply retrospectively and an earlier version does not apply to a later transaction.

**Interpretive guidance.** The applicability by date clause delineates the specific temporal scope of the current version of the policy, making it clear that only transactions dated within the defined period are subject to its provisions. This is particularly important in managing expectations and ensuring that employees are aware of which policy version governs their claims. By establishing that later versions do not apply retrospectively, the clause protects employees from potential confusion and ensures that they adhere to the most relevant guidelines for their specific transactions, thereby promoting consistency in expense management.

A common misconception regarding this clause is the belief that earlier versions of the policy can still be applied to later transactions, leading to potential discrepancies in expense claims. This misunderstanding can create confusion among employees about which rules they should follow. This topic is closely related to the circulars clause, as both emphasize the importance of understanding the effective dates of policies and amendments. Recognizing the applicability of policy versions helps employees navigate the expense process more effectively and ensures compliance with the correct guidelines.

### **GEP24-5.2 - Mixed expenses**

A bill that combines personal and business items must be itemised. If the business amount cannot be separated from the personal amount, the claim is returned for the business amount rather than approved in full.

**Interpretive guidance.** The mixed expenses clause addresses the treatment of bills that contain both personal and business items, establishing a requirement for itemization. This provision is particularly relevant in situations where employees submit claims that do not clearly separate business-related expenses from personal ones. By mandating itemization, the clause ensures that only legitimate business expenses are reimbursed, thereby safeguarding the company's financial interests and promoting responsible spending practices among employees. This clarity helps to streamline the claims process and reinforces the importance of transparency in expense reporting.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that a claim can be approved in full if it includes both personal and business expenses, provided the employee asserts that the business portion is valid. This can lead to improper reimbursements and potential compliance issues. This topic is conceptually linked to the insufficient evidence clause, as both emphasize the importance of clear documentation and the necessity of substantiating claims with appropriate evidence. Understanding the implications of mixed expenses helps employees navigate the claims process more effectively and ensures adherence to the policy.

# Global Expense Policy 2025

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## GE25-1.1 - Purpose and scope

This policy governs reimbursement of business expenses incurred by employees of Northstar Analytics Group and its subsidiaries for transactions dated between 1 January 2025 and 31 December 2025. Transactions dated in another calendar year are governed by the policy version published for that year.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the temporal framework within which employees of Northstar Analytics Group and its subsidiaries may seek reimbursement for business expenses. This policy specifically governs transactions that occur within the designated calendar year, ensuring that all claims are processed under the relevant guidelines applicable to that timeframe. Typical business situations covered by this clause include travel expenses, office supplies, and other operational costs incurred by employees while performing their duties, thereby aligning with the company's financial accountability and operational efficiency.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that expenses incurred outside the specified calendar year can be submitted for reimbursement under the same policy. In reality, such expenses must adhere to the guidelines of the policy version applicable to their respective years, which may differ in terms of requirements and permissible expenses. This clause is conceptually related to the documentation and submission requirements, as it emphasizes the importance of adhering to the correct policy version, which is essential for ensuring compliance with the overall expense management framework.

## GE25-1.2 - Business purpose

Expenses must primarily support company business. Mixed personal and business expenses require itemisation and only the documented business portion may be considered.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to establish that expenses must primarily support the business objectives of Northstar Analytics Group. It is intended to ensure that financial resources are allocated effectively and responsibly, thereby promoting a culture of fiscal prudence within the organization. Typical situations include travel for client meetings, training sessions, or other business-related activities, where employees may incur costs that are directly tied to their professional responsibilities. The emphasis on itemization for mixed personal and business expenses further underscores the need for transparency and accountability in financial reporting.

A frequent misconception is that any expense incurred during the course of work is automatically eligible for reimbursement. However, the requirement for expenses to primarily support business activities means that personal expenditures, even when mixed with business purposes, must be clearly delineated and justified. This clause is closely related to the documentation requirements, as both emphasize the necessity of providing clear and sufficient information to substantiate claims, ensuring that the company maintains a rigorous approach to expense management.

## GE25-1.3 - Documentation

A claim must state the merchant, transaction date, currency, total amount and a description sufficient to determine the business purpose. Category policies may require additional fields; where a required field is absent the claim cannot be approved.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to outline the necessary documentation required for submitting expense claims, ensuring that all submissions are complete and verifiable. By mandating specific fields such as merchant name, transaction date, and a description of the business purpose, this clause aims to facilitate a streamlined review process, thereby enhancing operational efficiency. Typical business situations include the submission of claims for travel expenses, office supplies, or client entertainment, where detailed information is crucial for assessing the validity of the expense.

One common misunderstanding is the belief that any claim can be submitted without adhering to the specified documentation requirements. In reality, the absence of required fields will result in the inability to approve the claim, which can lead to delays and frustration for the employee. This clause is conceptually linked to the submission window and late submission policies, as both highlight the importance of timely and accurate submissions, reinforcing the company's commitment to maintaining a structured and accountable expense management system.

## GE25-2.1 - Submission window

Claims must be submitted within 45 calendar days of the transaction date. A claim submitted from day 46 up to and including day 90 requires manager approval. A claim submitted after day 90 is escalated to Finance.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the timeline within which employees must submit their expense claims for reimbursement, thereby promoting timely reporting and accountability. By setting a clear submission window, the policy aims to facilitate efficient processing of claims, ensuring that the financial records remain up-to-date and accurate. Typical business situations that this clause addresses include travel reimbursements, training expenses, and other operational costs that employees may incur, emphasizing the importance of adhering to the specified timeframe for submission.

A common misconception is that claims can be submitted at any time without consequence, leading to potential delays in reimbursement. However, the stipulation that claims submitted beyond the initial submission window require additional manager approval underscores the necessity of adhering to the established timelines. This clause is interconnected with the late submission policy, as both highlight the importance of timely submissions and the potential ramifications of failing to comply with the established deadlines, thereby reinforcing the company's commitment to efficient financial management.

### **GEP25-2.2 - Late submission and outage relief**

Late submission tiers are counted in calendar days from the transaction date to the submission date. Formally recorded Finance system outage relief is published by circular and applies only to transactions dated inside the stated outage window.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to provide clarity regarding the handling of late submissions and the relief available in the event of formally recorded Finance system outages. By outlining the tiers for late submissions, the policy aims to establish a fair and transparent process for employees who may face challenges in submitting their claims on time. Typical business situations include unforeseen circumstances that may prevent timely submission, such as technical issues or emergencies, thereby ensuring that employees are not unduly penalized in such cases.

A frequent misunderstanding is that all late submissions can be easily justified without adhering to the outlined tiers. In reality, the policy specifies that claims submitted beyond the initial window require manager approval, and those submitted after a certain period are escalated to Finance, which may complicate the approval process. This clause is conceptually related to the submission window policy, as both emphasize the importance of adhering to timelines while providing a structured approach to managing exceptions, thereby ensuring that the company maintains a robust expense management framework.

### **GEP25-2.3 - Currency**

Thresholds expressed in SGD equivalent are tested as set out in the Currency and FX Handling Policy. Ceilings expressed in a local currency are tested in that currency without conversion.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the treatment of thresholds related to currency conversions within the context of the company's expense policies. It is particularly relevant in situations where expenses may be incurred in various currencies, necessitating a consistent approach to evaluating these expenses against established ceilings. By specifying the handling of thresholds in both the local currency and its equivalent in another currency, the clause ensures that all employees understand the parameters for expense reporting and compliance, particularly when engaging in international business transactions or when expenses are incurred during travel.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause may arise from the interpretation of how conversions should be applied to different currencies. Employees may mistakenly believe that all expenses must be converted to a single currency for evaluation, which is not the case when local currency ceilings are applicable. This topic is closely related to the Currency and FX Handling Policy, which provides further guidance on the processes for currency conversion and the management of foreign exchange risks. Understanding the distinctions between local and converted thresholds is essential for accurate expense reporting and compliance.

### **GEP25-3.1 - Order of precedence**

Where rules differ, the order of precedence is: law and regulation; the applicable regional addendum; a Finance circular from its effective date, which amends the clause it names; an approved written exception within its stated scope; the category policy; this global policy; and finally definitions, frequently asked questions and worked examples, which never override the clauses above.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear hierarchy of rules that govern the interpretation and application of the company's expense policies. In situations where multiple rules may apply or when there is ambiguity in the policy language, this order of precedence ensures that decisions are made consistently and in accordance with the highest authority. This is particularly relevant in complex business scenarios where regional addenda or specific Finance circulars may introduce variations to the global policy, thereby necessitating a structured approach to resolve conflicts and guide decision-making.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that all documents carry equal weight in decision-making. In reality, the hierarchy outlined here emphasizes that legal and regulatory requirements take precedence over internal policies and guidelines. This clause is closely related to the concept of circulars, as it highlights the importance of understanding the effective date of amendments and how they interact with existing policies. Furthermore, it underscores the necessity of adhering to the defined order of precedence when interpreting conflicting rules, thereby ensuring compliance and uniformity in policy application.

### **GEP25-3.2 - Circulars**

A Finance circular amends the clause it names from its effective date only. A transaction dated before the effective date is decided under the value that applied on its own transaction date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause clarifies that a Finance circular modifies the specific clause it references from the date it becomes effective, ensuring that any transactions dated prior to this effective date are governed by the rules in place at that time. This is essential for maintaining consistency and fairness in the treatment of transactions, especially in dynamic business environments where policies may evolve. In practice, this clause is particularly relevant for employees submitting claims or engaging in financial transactions that may be affected by recent policy changes, as it delineates the timeframe for which each set of rules applies.

A frequent misconception is that circulars retroactively apply to transactions dated before their effective date, which is not the case according to this clause. It is crucial to understand that the effective date is a key factor in determining which rules govern a transaction. This topic is conceptually linked to the order of precedence, as both clauses work together to clarify the application of rules and the importance of timing in policy enforcement. Misinterpretation of these clauses can lead to disputes or confusion regarding the validity of claims, highlighting the need for careful attention to detail in financial documentation.

### **GEP25-4.1 - Insufficient evidence**

If a mandatory fact cannot be determined from the claim or from approved enterprise records, the reviewer requests the missing information from the employee. Facts must not be inferred from the employee narrative when an authoritative record exists.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves the purpose of ensuring that all claims submitted for reimbursement are supported by verifiable evidence. In situations where mandatory facts are absent from the claim or cannot be substantiated by existing enterprise records, it is the responsibility of the reviewer to seek clarification from the employee. This process is vital for maintaining the integrity of the expense reporting system and ensuring that all claims are legitimate and accurately reflect business expenditures, thereby protecting the company from potential financial discrepancies.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the assumption that employee narratives can be used as sufficient evidence in the absence of authoritative records. However, this clause explicitly states that facts must not be inferred from narratives when reliable documentation is available. This topic is closely related to the human review process, as both clauses emphasize the importance of thorough verification and adherence to established guidelines when assessing claims. Proper documentation is essential not only for compliance but also for fostering a culture of accountability within the organization.

### **GEP25-4.2 - Human review**

A claim is escalated to Finance where two rules conflict and precedence cannot be determined from published text, where an approval conflicts with the transaction facts, or where the amount exceeds the Finance review threshold in the Approval Authority Policy.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to outline the circumstances under which a claim must be escalated to the Finance department for further review. This escalation occurs when there are conflicting rules, discrepancies between approvals and transaction facts, or when the claim exceeds a specified threshold. This process is crucial for ensuring that all claims are evaluated with the appropriate level of scrutiny, particularly in complex cases where standard procedures may not provide clear guidance. By establishing a

formal review process, the company aims to uphold the integrity of its financial practices and ensure compliance with its policies.

A common misunderstanding is that all claims should automatically be escalated whenever there is a conflict or ambiguity, which is not the intent of this clause. Escalation is reserved for specific scenarios as defined, and not all conflicts warrant this level of intervention. This clause is conceptually linked to the principles of insufficient evidence and the order of precedence, as both emphasize the importance of clarity and adherence to established processes in the review of claims. Understanding the nuances of these policies is essential for ensuring that claims are processed efficiently and accurately.

### **GEP25-5.1 - Applicability by date**

This policy version applies only to transactions dated in 2025. A later version does not apply retrospectively and an earlier version does not apply to a later transaction.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause specifies the applicability of the current version of the policy, indicating that it is only relevant for transactions dated within a specific timeframe. This is crucial for ensuring that employees are aware of which version of the policy governs their claims, thereby preventing confusion and ensuring compliance with the most current rules. In practice, this clause is particularly important during transitional periods when new policies are introduced, as it helps to delineate the boundaries of applicability and reinforces the need for employees to be vigilant about the dates associated with their transactions.

A common misunderstanding is the belief that the latest version of the policy applies retroactively to all past transactions, which is not the case as outlined in this clause. It is essential to recognize that each version of a policy is distinct and only applies to transactions dated within its effective period. This topic is closely related to the order of precedence and circulars, as both emphasize the importance of understanding the temporal context in which policies operate. Misinterpretation of these clauses can lead to improper claims submissions and potential compliance issues, underscoring the importance of clarity in policy communication.

### **GEP25-5.2 - Mixed expenses**

A bill that combines personal and business items must be itemised. If the business amount cannot be separated from the personal amount, the claim is returned for the business amount rather than approved in full.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure that any expense claim that includes both personal and business items is clearly itemized. This requirement is essential for maintaining transparency and accountability in expense reporting, as it allows for a clear distinction between allowable business expenses and personal expenditures. In situations where a bill cannot be effectively separated into its business and personal components, the clause mandates that the claim be returned for further clarification. This process helps to uphold the integrity of the expense management system and ensures that only legitimate business expenses are approved for reimbursement.

A common misunderstanding is that claims can be approved in full even when they contain mixed expenses, which contradicts the intent of this clause. It is crucial to recognize that itemization is not merely a formality but a necessary step to ensure compliance with policy requirements. This topic is conceptually linked to the principles of insufficient evidence, as both emphasize the importance of clear documentation and verification in the claims process. Proper itemization not only facilitates accurate processing of claims but also reinforces a culture of responsibility and ethical financial practices within the organization.

### **GEP25-6.1 - Evidence standard**

A decision must cite the applicable clause and every enterprise fact that the clause requires. The travel request is the authoritative source for trip approval and destination; employee narrative never overrides a system record.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear evidentiary standard for decision-making related to travel requests. It ensures that all decisions are grounded in the relevant policy framework and that the travel request serves as the primary document for trip approval and destination details. This clause is particularly relevant in situations where there may be discrepancies between an employee's narrative and the official records, thereby safeguarding the integrity of the approval process and ensuring compliance with established guidelines.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause may arise from the belief that an employee's narrative can supersede the travel request documentation. It is crucial to recognize that the travel request is the definitive source of information for trip approvals. This clause is conceptually linked to other policy areas, such as

documentation standards and accountability measures, reinforcing the importance of accurate record-keeping and adherence to prescribed procedures.

# Global Expense Policy 2026

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## GEP26-1.1 - Purpose and scope

This policy governs reimbursement of business expenses incurred by employees of Northstar Analytics Group and its subsidiaries for transactions dated between 1 January 2026 and 31 December 2026. Transactions dated in another calendar year are governed by the policy version published for that year.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the purpose and scope of the reimbursement policy, specifically targeting business expenses incurred by employees during a defined calendar year. It provides clarity on which transactions are eligible for reimbursement, ensuring that employees are aware of the temporal limitations of the policy. This is particularly important in situations where employees may seek reimbursement for expenses incurred outside the specified timeframe, thereby preventing confusion and ensuring compliance with the governing policy for each year.

A common misunderstanding might involve the assumption that expenses incurred outside the specified dates can still be reimbursed under this policy. It is essential to understand that each year's policy is distinct and must be adhered to accordingly. This clause is related to other policy topics, such as documentation and submission requirements, as it underscores the need for employees to be aware of the temporal context of their expenses when seeking reimbursement.

## GEP26-1.2 - Business purpose

Every expense must have a specific, auditable business purpose. Generic wording such as business expense or client activity is insufficient where a category policy requires named attendees, a route, an event, or a project.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure that every business expense claimed by employees is justifiable and can be audited effectively. By requiring a specific business purpose for each expense, the policy aims to eliminate vague or generic descriptions that may lead to misunderstandings or misuse of funds. This clause is particularly relevant in scenarios where expenses could be scrutinized, such as during audits or when justifying expenditures to stakeholders.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the belief that any mention of a business context suffices for expense justification. However, generic terms like 'business expense' do not meet the standards set forth in this clause. This topic is conceptually linked to documentation requirements, as both emphasize the need for clarity and specificity in expense reporting, thereby fostering accountability and transparency in financial practices.

## GEP26-1.3 - Documentation

A claim must state the merchant, transaction date, currency, total amount and a description sufficient to determine the business purpose. Category policies may require additional fields; where a required field is absent the claim cannot be approved.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the documentation requirements necessary for the approval of expense claims. By specifying the essential details that must be included, such as merchant information and transaction descriptions, the policy aims to facilitate a thorough review process. This is particularly important in business scenarios where the legitimacy of expenses needs to be verified, ensuring that all claims can be traced back to a valid business purpose.

Common misunderstandings may occur when employees submit claims that lack the required details, believing that their narrative alone suffices for approval. It is crucial to recognize that missing information can lead to claim denial. This clause is closely related to the business purpose requirement, as both emphasize the importance of detailed and accurate documentation in supporting the legitimacy of expenses.

## GEP26-2.1 - Submission window

Claims must be submitted within 45 calendar days of the transaction date. A claim submitted from day 46 up to and including day 75 requires manager approval. A claim submitted after day 75 is escalated to Finance.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear timeline for the submission of expense claims, thereby promoting timely processing and accountability. By setting specific submission windows, the policy aims to streamline the reimbursement process and ensure that claims are handled efficiently. This is particularly relevant in business situations where delays in submission could affect cash flow or financial reporting.

A common misunderstanding might be the belief that claims can be submitted at any time without consequence. However, this clause clearly outlines the consequences of late submissions, which can lead to additional approval requirements. This topic is conceptually linked to the late submission and outage relief clause, as both address the importance of adhering to timelines and the implications of failing to do so.

### **GEP26-2.2 - Late submission and outage relief**

Late submission tiers are counted in calendar days from the transaction date to the submission date. Formally recorded Finance system outage relief is published by circular and applies only to transactions dated inside the stated outage window.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to provide clarity on the treatment of late submissions and the circumstances under which relief may be granted due to system outages. By defining the parameters for late submissions, the policy aims to maintain a fair and consistent approach to expense claims. This is particularly important in situations where employees may be affected by unforeseen technical issues, ensuring that they are not unduly penalized for circumstances beyond their control.

A common misunderstanding may involve the assumption that all late submissions are treated equally, without regard for the context of the delay. However, this clause specifies that only formally recorded outages will be considered for relief. This topic is related to submission windows, as both emphasize the importance of timely claims while also recognizing the need for flexibility in certain situations.

### **GEP26-2.3 - Currency**

Thresholds expressed in SGD equivalent are tested as set out in the Currency and FX Handling Policy. Ceilings expressed in a local currency are tested in that currency without conversion.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish clear guidelines for the evaluation of financial thresholds, ensuring that they are tested appropriately in the relevant currency. This is particularly important in international transactions where currency fluctuations can significantly impact financial reporting and compliance. The clause is designed to cover situations where expenses or financial limits are expressed in different currencies, thus providing a framework for consistency and accuracy in financial assessments.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the belief that all financial thresholds can be converted into a single currency for evaluation purposes. However, the clause emphasizes that ceilings expressed in local currencies must be assessed without conversion, which can lead to confusion in multi-currency environments. This topic is conceptually linked to the Currency and FX Handling Policy, as both address the handling of different currencies in financial transactions, ensuring that employees understand the importance of adhering to the specified guidelines.

### **GEP26-3.1 - Order of precedence**

Where rules differ, the order of precedence is: law and regulation; the applicable regional addendum; a Finance circular from its effective date, which amends the clause it names; an approved written exception within its stated scope; the category policy; this global policy; and finally definitions, frequently asked questions and worked examples, which never override the clauses above.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the hierarchy of rules applicable within the organization, ensuring that employees understand which regulations take precedence in situations where discrepancies arise. It is essential for maintaining compliance and consistency across various policies and regulations, particularly in complex scenarios involving legal requirements, regional adaptations, and internal directives. By establishing a clear order of precedence, the clause helps mitigate confusion and potential conflicts in decision-making processes.

A frequent misconception is that all policies hold equal weight, leading to potential conflicts in interpretation. This clause makes it clear that certain rules, such as laws and regulations, take precedence over others, which can be vital in ensuring compliance with external requirements. This topic is closely related to the concept of policy governance, as it underscores the importance of understanding the relationships between different policy documents and their implications for operational decisions.

### **GEP26-3.2 - Circulars**

A Finance circular amends the clause it names from its effective date only. A transaction dated before the effective date is decided under the value that applied on its own transaction date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the effective date of Finance circulars and their impact on previously dated transactions. This is crucial for ensuring that employees apply the correct version of a policy when processing transactions, thereby maintaining compliance and accuracy in financial reporting. By specifying that amendments take effect only from their stated date, the clause helps to prevent confusion and ensures that all transactions are evaluated based on the rules that were in effect at the time of their occurrence.

A common misunderstanding is that circulars can retroactively affect transactions that occurred prior to their effective date. This clause clarifies that only transactions dated on or after the effective date are subject to the amendments, which is essential for maintaining the integrity of financial records. This topic is related to the broader theme of policy updates and their implications, emphasizing the need for employees to stay informed about changes in policy and how they apply to ongoing transactions.

#### **GEP26-4.1 - Insufficient evidence**

If a mandatory fact cannot be determined from the claim or from approved enterprise records, the reviewer requests the missing information from the employee. Facts must not be inferred from the employee narrative when an authoritative record exists.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause is designed to ensure that all claims submitted for review are substantiated by adequate evidence, thereby promoting transparency and accountability within the expense reporting process. In situations where mandatory facts are missing, the reviewer is empowered to request additional information from the employee, ensuring that claims are thoroughly vetted before approval. This process is vital for maintaining the integrity of financial records and ensuring compliance with internal policies.

A common misconception is that the reviewer can make assumptions based on the employee's narrative when authoritative records are available. The clause explicitly states that facts must not be inferred, which can lead to misunderstandings regarding the review process. This topic is conceptually linked to the principles of evidence-based decision-making and the importance of maintaining accurate records, reinforcing the need for thorough documentation in all financial transactions.

#### **GEP26-4.2 - Human review**

A claim is escalated to Finance where two rules conflict and precedence cannot be determined from published text, where an approval conflicts with the transaction facts, or where the amount exceeds the Finance review threshold in the Approval Authority Policy.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a protocol for escalating claims to the Finance department when conflicts arise that cannot be resolved through the existing policy framework. By outlining specific scenarios that trigger this escalation, the clause ensures that complex cases receive appropriate attention and expertise, thereby safeguarding the integrity of the expense approval process. This is particularly important in situations where conflicting rules or approvals could lead to financial discrepancies.

A common misunderstanding is that all claims can be resolved at the initial review level, without recognizing the need for escalation in more complex cases. This clause clarifies that certain situations necessitate a higher level of scrutiny, which is essential for maintaining compliance and accuracy. This topic is closely related to the Approval Authority Policy, as it highlights the importance of understanding the thresholds and conditions under which claims should be escalated for further review.

#### **GEP26-5.1 - Applicability by date**

This policy version applies only to transactions dated in 2026. A later version does not apply retrospectively and an earlier version does not apply to a later transaction.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to define the applicability of the current version of the policy, ensuring that employees understand which transactions are governed by the specified guidelines. By clearly stating that this version applies only to transactions dated in a specific year, the clause helps to maintain clarity and consistency in the application of policy rules. This is particularly important in environments where multiple versions of a policy may exist, as it prevents confusion regarding which rules are applicable to specific transactions.

A common misconception is that earlier versions of the policy can still apply to later transactions, leading to potential inconsistencies in expense reporting. This clause explicitly states that only the current version is applicable, which is crucial for maintaining the integrity of financial processes. This topic is related to policy

lifecycle management, emphasizing the importance of keeping employees informed about the most current policies and ensuring that they understand the implications of policy changes on their transactions.

### **GEP26-5.2 - Mixed expenses**

A bill that combines personal and business items must be itemised. If the business amount cannot be separated from the personal amount, the claim is returned for the business amount rather than approved in full.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure clarity and accountability in expense reporting by requiring itemisation of bills that contain both personal and business-related items. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees may incur mixed expenses during business activities, such as dining or travel, where personal and professional expenditures are intertwined. By mandating itemisation, the company aims to facilitate accurate expense tracking and reimbursement processes, thus safeguarding corporate resources and maintaining compliance with financial policies.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that any mixed expense can be fully reimbursed if the employee asserts it was primarily for business purposes. However, the requirement for itemisation clarifies that only the business-related portion is eligible for reimbursement. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies regarding expense eligibility and reimbursement procedures, as it underscores the necessity for clear delineation between personal and business expenses, which is critical for maintaining financial integrity within the organisation.

### **GEP26-6.1 - Evidence standard**

A decision must cite the applicable clause and every enterprise fact that the clause requires. The travel request is the authoritative source for trip approval and destination; employee narrative never overrides a system record.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the evidence standard necessary for making decisions regarding expense claims and travel requests. It is designed to ensure that all decisions are grounded in documented facts and that the travel request is the primary source of authority for trip approvals. This is particularly important in situations where discrepancies may arise, as it provides a clear framework for validating claims and ensuring that all relevant information is considered, thereby promoting fairness and consistency in the decision-making process.

A common misconception is that employee narratives or explanations can override the established evidence requirements. In reality, the clause clarifies that only documented travel requests can substantiate approvals, thereby reinforcing the importance of accurate record-keeping. This principle is closely related to the broader context of compliance and governance within the organisation, as it ensures that all financial transactions are supported by verifiable evidence, which is critical for audits and financial reporting.

### **GEP26-6.2 - Automation boundary**

Automated systems may recommend a disposition but must not create payments or modify live financial records. All automated recommendations are logged with the evidence relied on.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the boundaries of automated systems in the context of financial transactions. It specifies that while automated systems may provide recommendations regarding expense dispositions, they lack the authority to execute payments or alter live financial records. This is particularly relevant in scenarios where efficiency and accuracy are paramount, as it allows for streamlined processes while ensuring that human oversight remains integral to financial decision-making.

A frequent misunderstanding is that automated recommendations can be treated as definitive approvals for financial transactions. However, this clause clarifies that such recommendations are merely advisory and do not replace the need for human intervention in executing financial actions. This topic intersects with related policies on internal controls and financial governance, as it highlights the importance of maintaining a clear separation between automated processes and human oversight to mitigate risks associated with financial inaccuracies.

# Travel and Accommodation Policy

Document ID Do4 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category travel

## TRV-1.1 - Trip authorisation

Hotel and airfare expenses require an approved business trip covering the transaction date, evidenced by the travel request record, unless a valid written exception removes the requirement. A request that is pending, rejected or absent does not evidence approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the requirements for trip authorisation, specifically regarding hotel and airfare expenses. It ensures that these expenses are only reimbursed when they are linked to an approved business trip, as evidenced by the travel request record. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees may incur travel-related costs in anticipation of business activities, as it establishes a clear connection between the incurred expenses and the necessary approvals, thereby promoting fiscal responsibility.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume expenses can be reimbursed based on verbal confirmations or informal approvals. The clause clearly states that only documented approvals, as indicated in the travel request record, are valid. This principle is closely related to the policies governing travel request statuses, as it reinforces the necessity for formal authorisation processes to ensure that all travel-related expenses are appropriately vetted and aligned with company policy.

## TRV-1.2 - Travel request statuses

A travel request has one of the statuses APPROVED, PENDING or REJECTED. Only APPROVED evidences an authorised trip. A request may reference a conference event identifier and an exception identifier, which are then looked up in their own records.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to define the statuses of travel requests, which are crucial for determining the validity of trip authorisations. It establishes that only requests marked as APPROVED can substantiate an authorised trip, thereby providing a clear framework for employees to understand the implications of their travel request status. This is particularly important in managing expectations and ensuring that employees are aware of the necessary approvals before incurring expenses related to travel.

A common misconception is that a travel request in PENDING status can be treated as an approval for expense reimbursement. However, this clause clarifies that only APPROVED requests are valid for such purposes, thereby preventing potential misuse of the reimbursement process. This topic is interconnected with the policies on trip authorisation and expense reimbursement, as it underscores the importance of adhering to established procedures to maintain the integrity of the expense management system.

## TRV-2.1 - Hotel principles

Hotel accommodation is reimbursable for single occupancy during an approved business trip up to the nightly ceiling for the destination tier and the employee grade band. The employee grade is taken from the employee profile record.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the principles governing hotel accommodation reimbursements during approved business trips. It specifies that reimbursement is applicable for single occupancy and is subject to certain criteria related to the destination and employee grade band. This is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees are required to travel for business purposes, as it provides clear guidelines on what constitutes reimbursable lodging expenses, thereby ensuring consistency and fairness in the reimbursement process.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume any hotel expense incurred during a business trip is automatically reimbursable. However, this clause clarifies that reimbursement is contingent upon adherence to specific principles, including occupancy limits and destination-related criteria. This policy is conceptually linked to other travel-related policies, as it emphasizes the importance of aligning expenses with approved travel parameters to uphold the organisation's financial standards and accountability.

## TRV-2.2 - Location tiers

Destinations are classified into ceiling tiers as follows.

| City      | Ceiling tier |
|-----------|--------------|
| Singapore | SG-CENTRAL   |

|           |          |
|-----------|----------|
| Mumbai    | IN-T1    |
| Delhi     | IN-T1    |
| Bengaluru | IN-T1    |
| Pune      | IN-T2    |
| Jaipur    | IN-T2    |
| Kochi     | IN-T2    |
| Tokyo     | JP-TOKYO |
| Osaka     | JP-MAJOR |
| Nagoya    | JP-MAJOR |
| Yokohama  | JP-MAJOR |
| Fukuoka   | JP-OTHER |
| Sapporo   | JP-OTHER |
| Sendai    | JP-OTHER |

A city not listed takes the lowest tier for its country.

**Interpretive guidance.** The classification of destinations into ceiling tiers serves to standardize travel expenses across various locations, facilitating budget management and ensuring equitable treatment of employees traveling for business purposes. By categorizing cities into specific tiers, the policy delineates expected accommodation costs based on the geographical and economic context of each destination. This clause typically applies to travel arrangements, enabling employees to understand the limits on lodging expenses when traveling to different cities, thereby promoting responsible spending and adherence to the company's financial guidelines.

A common misunderstanding regarding this classification is the assumption that all cities not explicitly listed fall into a higher tier than designated. In reality, any city not mentioned defaults to the lowest tier for its respective country, which may lead to unintentional over-expenditure if employees are not aware of this stipulation. This clause is closely related to the subsequent policies on nightly hotel ceilings, as it directly informs the applicable ceilings based on the tier classification, thereby ensuring that travel expenses remain within the established financial framework.

### TRV-3.1 - Nightly hotel ceilings 2024

The nightly base ceilings for transactions dated in 2024 are set out below in local currency. The ceiling is compared with the nightly rate, which is the total accommodation charge divided by the number of nights.

| Location tier | Currency | G1-G3  | G4-G5  | G6-G7  | G8+    |
|---------------|----------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| SG-CENTRAL    | SGD      | 280    | 330    | 390    | 480    |
| IN-T1         | INR      | 9,000  | 12,000 | 16,000 | 21,000 |
| IN-T2         | INR      | 6,000  | 8,500  | 11,000 | 15,000 |
| JP-TOKYO      | JPY      | 28,000 | 32,000 | 38,000 | 46,000 |
| JP-MAJOR      | JPY      | 24,000 | 28,000 | 34,000 | 41,000 |
| JP-OTHER      | JPY      | 20,000 | 24,000 | 29,000 | 35,000 |

Circular amendments to a row apply from their effective date as set out in the Finance Circulars.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of establishing nightly hotel ceilings for transactions dated in a specific year is to create a clear and consistent framework for accommodation expenses during business travel. This policy ensures that employees are aware of the maximum allowable costs for hotel stays, which varies by location tier. By setting these ceilings, the company aims to manage travel budgets effectively while providing employees with appropriate accommodation options that align with the company's financial objectives and travel policies.

A frequent misconception is that the ceilings are fixed and unchangeable throughout the year, whereas they may be subject to amendments based on the Finance Circulars. Employees might also confuse the ceilings with the actual costs of accommodation, not realizing that the ceilings serve as guidelines rather than guarantees of reimbursement. This clause is conceptually linked to the location tier classification, as the ceilings are determined based on the tier assigned to each destination, ensuring that travel expenses are aligned with the economic conditions of different locations.

### TRV-3.2 - Nightly hotel ceilings 2025

The nightly base ceilings for transactions dated in 2025 are set out below in local currency. The ceiling is compared with the nightly rate, which is the total accommodation charge divided by the number of nights.

| Location tier | Currency | G1-G3  | G4-G5  | G6-G7  | G8+    |
|---------------|----------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| SG-CENTRAL    | SGD      | 300    | 350    | 410    | 500    |
| IN-T1         | INR      | 10,000 | 13,000 | 17,000 | 22,000 |
| IN-T2         | INR      | 6,500  | 9,000  | 11,800 | 16,000 |
| JP-TOKYO      | JPY      | 30,000 | 34,000 | 40,000 | 49,000 |
| JP-MAJOR      | JPY      | 25,500 | 29,500 | 35,500 | 43,000 |
| JP-OTHER      | JPY      | 21,500 | 25,500 | 30,500 | 37,000 |

Circular amendments to a row apply from their effective date as set out in the Finance Circulars.

**Interpretive guidance.** The establishment of nightly hotel ceilings for transactions dated in the following year serves to provide clarity and predictability for employees planning business travel. By outlining specific ceilings for various location tiers, the policy ensures that employees have a clear understanding of the maximum allowable accommodation expenses for their trips. This proactive approach assists in budget management and promotes adherence to company policies regarding travel expenditures, thereby supporting overall financial discipline within the organization.

A common misunderstanding is that these ceilings are permanent and do not change, leading employees to overlook potential updates communicated through Finance Circulars. Additionally, some may misinterpret the ceilings as the standard rates for accommodations rather than maximum allowable expenses, which could result in confusion during the reimbursement process. This clause is closely related to the previous policy on nightly hotel ceilings, as it continues the practice of establishing limits based on location tiers, ensuring consistency and clarity in travel expense management.

### TRV-3.3 - Nightly hotel ceilings 2026

The nightly base ceilings for transactions dated in 2026 are set out below in local currency. The ceiling is compared with the nightly rate, which is the total accommodation charge divided by the number of nights.

| Location tier | Currency | G1-G3  | G4-G5  | G6-G7  | G8+    |
|---------------|----------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| SG-CENTRAL    | SGD      | 320    | 370    | 430    | 520    |
| IN-T1         | INR      | 11,000 | 14,500 | 18,500 | 24,000 |
| IN-T2         | INR      | 7,000  | 9,800  | 12,800 | 17,500 |
| JP-TOKYO      | JPY      | 32,000 | 36,000 | 42,000 | 52,000 |
| JP-MAJOR      | JPY      | 27,500 | 31,500 | 37,500 | 46,000 |
| JP-OTHER      | JPY      | 23,000 | 27,000 | 32,500 | 39,500 |

Circular amendments to a row apply from their effective date as set out in the Finance Circulars.

**Interpretive guidance.** The implementation of nightly hotel ceilings for transactions dated in a subsequent year continues the company's commitment to maintaining a structured approach to travel expenses. By defining specific ceilings for various location tiers, the policy provides employees with a clear framework for understanding the maximum allowable accommodation costs. This clarity is essential for effective budget management and helps ensure that employees make informed decisions when booking accommodations for business travel.

A prevalent misunderstanding is the assumption that these ceilings will remain unchanged indefinitely, which may lead employees to disregard updates issued through Finance Circulars. Furthermore, there may be confusion regarding the distinction between the ceilings and actual accommodation rates, with some employees perceiving the ceilings as standard rates rather than maximum allowances. This clause is inherently linked to the preceding policies on nightly hotel ceilings, as it reinforces the tier-based structure for managing accommodation expenses, thereby ensuring consistency across different fiscal years.

### TRV-3.4 - Applying amendments

A percentage amendment to a hotel row is applied to the base ceiling for the transaction year, rounded half up to the rounding unit stated in the circular. An amendment does not compound with another amendment on the same row in the same year.

**Interpretive guidance.** The policy regarding applying amendments to hotel ceilings is designed to provide flexibility in managing accommodation costs while ensuring that adjustments are systematically applied and clearly communicated. By allowing for percentage amendments to be applied to the base ceiling, the company

can respond to changing market conditions and inflation rates, thereby maintaining a relevant and fair approach to travel expenses. This clause is particularly important for ensuring that employees are aware of how their accommodation allowances may fluctuate based on external factors, fostering transparency in expense management.

A common misunderstanding is that amendments can be compounded, leading to confusion about how multiple changes might affect the ceiling for a given year. Employees may mistakenly believe that applying several amendments would result in a higher maximum allowable rate, whereas the policy explicitly states that such compounding is not permitted. This clause is related to the previous policies on nightly hotel ceilings, as it outlines how adjustments to those ceilings will be managed, ensuring that the company maintains control over travel expenses while accommodating necessary changes.

#### **TRV-4.1 - Long stays**

For a stay of more than 14 nights, from 1 January 2025, the ceiling applied to the nightly rate is 90 percent of the ceiling that would otherwise apply.

**Interpretive guidance.** The provision regarding long stays is intended to address the unique circumstances that arise when employees are required to travel for extended periods. By applying a modified ceiling for accommodations exceeding a specified duration, the policy aims to balance the need for cost-effective lodging with the realities of longer business engagements. This approach not only promotes responsible spending but also recognizes the potential for different pricing structures associated with extended stays, thereby ensuring that employees are supported during their business trips.

A common misconception is that the modified ceiling applies uniformly to all long stays, without consideration of the specific circumstances or location. Employees may not fully understand that the reduced ceiling is designed to reflect the realities of long-term accommodations, which can differ significantly from standard rates. This clause is conceptually linked to the policies on nightly hotel ceilings, as it directly impacts the allowable rates based on the length of stay, ensuring that travel expenses remain within the company's financial parameters.

#### **TRV-4.2 - Nightly rate**

The nightly rate is the total accommodation charge on the bill divided by the number of nights stated on the claim. Incidentals billed separately are claimed under their own categories.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear method for calculating the nightly rate for accommodation expenses incurred during business travel. This calculation is essential in ensuring that reimbursement claims are accurate and align with the company's financial policies. Typical business situations covered by this clause include employees submitting expense reports for hotel stays during business trips, where the total accommodation charge needs to be divided by the number of nights stayed as indicated on the claim. This ensures consistency and fairness in how accommodation expenses are processed.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that all charges on a hotel bill are automatically included in the nightly rate calculation. However, it is important to note that only the accommodation charge is considered, while any incidentals must be claimed separately. This clause is conceptually related to other policies regarding travel expenses, particularly those addressing reimbursement limits and exceptions, as it helps delineate which costs are eligible for reimbursement and under what conditions.

#### **TRV-5.1 - Conference lodging**

Where the travel request references an approved conference, the Training and Conferences Policy is consulted before a hotel is rejected solely for exceeding the ordinary ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the process for lodging expenses associated with approved conferences. It emphasizes the importance of consulting the Training and Conferences Policy when evaluating hotel options, particularly when a hotel exceeds the ordinary ceiling for accommodation costs. This is crucial in ensuring that employees are not unduly penalized for choosing accommodations that may be more suitable for conference attendance, thereby supporting their professional development and networking opportunities.

A frequent misconception is that any hotel exceeding the ordinary ceiling is automatically disqualified for reimbursement. In reality, this clause allows for exceptions when the travel request pertains to an approved conference, thus linking it to the broader context of travel and training policies. This relationship underscores

the need for employees to be informed about the various policies that govern travel expenses, particularly those that pertain to professional development and the associated costs.

### **TRV-5.2 - Partner hotel uplift**

For a registered attendee of an approved conference staying at the official partner hotel named in the conference registry, the nightly ceiling is increased by 20 percent in 2024, 20 percent in 2025 and 25 percent in 2026. The uplift applies after any percentage amendment and before the long-stay factor.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to provide a structured uplift to the nightly ceiling for employees attending approved conferences who choose to stay at designated partner hotels. This uplift recognizes the unique circumstances of conference attendance, where accommodations may be priced higher due to proximity and convenience. It is particularly relevant in situations where employees are required to stay at partner hotels to enhance their conference experience and facilitate networking opportunities.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that the uplift applies universally to all hotel stays. In actuality, it is specifically tied to registered attendees of approved conferences and only applies to partner hotels listed in the conference registry. This clause is interconnected with other policies regarding ceiling exceptions and reimbursement limits, emphasizing the importance of understanding specific conditions under which additional costs may be justified.

### **TRV-6.1 - Ceiling exceptions**

A nightly rate above the applicable ceiling is reimbursable only through the partner hotel uplift or an approved hotel-limit exception under the Exceptions and Waivers Procedure.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the conditions under which reimbursement for accommodation expenses exceeding the applicable ceiling may be granted. It establishes that such reimbursements are permissible only through the partner hotel uplift or an approved hotel-limit exception. This is crucial for maintaining budgetary control and ensuring that all travel-related expenses align with the company's financial guidelines while still accommodating necessary exceptions.

A common misconception is that any expense exceeding the ceiling can be reimbursed without justification. However, this clause clearly delineates the specific pathways for reimbursement, which are limited to predefined exceptions. This clause is conceptually linked to the broader framework of expense management and approval processes, highlighting the importance of adhering to established guidelines while also allowing for necessary flexibility in exceptional circumstances.

### **TRV-6.2 - Evidence hierarchy**

The travel request is the authoritative source for trip approval, destination and linked identifiers. The description written by the employee cannot substitute for a missing record.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the travel request as the primary source of authority for trip-related approvals and details. This ensures that all travel activities are documented and verifiable, thereby facilitating accurate expense reporting and reimbursement processes. Typical situations covered include instances where employees submit claims for travel expenses and need to reference their travel request to substantiate their claims, ensuring consistency and accountability in expense management.

A common misunderstanding is the belief that any written description provided by the employee can serve as a substitute for the travel request. In reality, the clause emphasizes the necessity of official documentation to support claims. This clause is conceptually related to policies on documentation and record-keeping, reinforcing the need for employees to understand the importance of maintaining accurate records to support their expense claims.

### **TRV-7.1 - Personal extension**

Cost attributable to a personal extension of a business trip is not reimbursable. Where the comparison with the business-only stay is missing, the reviewer requests it.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause specifies that costs associated with personal extensions of business trips are not eligible for reimbursement. This is crucial for delineating between business-related expenses and personal expenditures, ensuring that the company's financial resources are utilized appropriately. Typical situations this clause addresses include employees who may wish to extend their business travel for personal reasons and need to understand the implications for reimbursement.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume that any costs incurred during a personal extension can be claimed. However, this clause clarifies that only expenses directly related to the business

purpose of the trip are reimbursable. This topic is conceptually linked to other policies regarding reimbursement eligibility and expense categorization, reinforcing the importance of clear distinctions between business and personal expenses in the context of corporate travel.

# Air and Rail Travel Standards

Document ID D05 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category travel

## AIR-1.1 - Standard cabin

Economy class is the standard cabin for all flights. Fares are booked through the corporate travel tool or a comparable fare is documented.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish economy class as the default travel option for all corporate flights, ensuring cost-effective travel arrangements for employees. This standardization aids in budget management and aligns with the company's commitment to responsible spending. Typical business situations covered by this clause include routine domestic and international travel for meetings, conferences, or client engagements, where economy class travel is deemed sufficient for the duration and nature of the trip.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume they can book any class of service without regard to the established standard. It is essential to recognize that this clause interacts with other travel-related policies, such as those governing exceptions and upgrades, which may apply in specific circumstances. Employees should familiarize themselves with the entire travel policy to ensure compliance and avoid potential discrepancies.

## AIR-2.1 - Premium economy

Premium economy is permitted where the scheduled flight time exceeds 6 hours and the traveller is grade G4 or above. The hours threshold is published in the schedule and may be amended by circular.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the conditions under which premium economy class travel is permissible, specifically for longer flights exceeding a designated duration and for employees at a specified grade level. The allowance for premium economy reflects the company's understanding of the need for comfort on extended journeys, which can enhance productivity and well-being. Typical scenarios include international travel for senior staff members attending critical business meetings or events that necessitate a higher level of comfort due to the flight duration.

A frequent misconception is that premium economy is available to all employees regardless of grade or flight length, leading to potential misuse of travel resources. This clause is closely linked to other travel policies that define eligibility for different classes of service, emphasizing the importance of understanding the hierarchy of travel options. Employees should be aware of the overall travel policy framework to ensure they are booking appropriately based on their specific circumstances.

## AIR-2.2 - Business class

Business class is permitted for grade G7 and above, or for grade G6 and above where the scheduled flight time exceeds 9 hours. Otherwise business class requires an approved travel exception naming the flight.

**Interpretive guidance.** The intent of this clause is to delineate the criteria under which business class travel is authorized, focusing on the employee's grade level and the length of the flight. This provision acknowledges that longer flights may necessitate additional comfort for employees in senior positions, thereby supporting their ability to perform effectively upon arrival. Typical situations include international business trips where the duration exceeds the stipulated threshold, allowing for a more restful travel experience for eligible employees.

A common misunderstanding is that employees at lower grades may believe they can access business class travel under various circumstances, leading to confusion regarding eligibility. This clause is interrelated with other travel policies that outline exceptions and approvals, reinforcing the need for clarity on travel class distinctions. Employees are encouraged to review the entire travel policy to fully understand their entitlements and the rationale behind the classifications.

## AIR-3.1 - Advance booking

A fare booked fewer than 14 days before departure requires manager approval. The days are counted from booking date to departure date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to regulate the timing of travel bookings, requiring managerial approval for fares booked within a specified timeframe before departure. The purpose is to promote advance planning and cost control, ensuring that travel expenses are kept within budgetary constraints. Typical business scenarios include last-minute travel arrangements for urgent meetings or events, where the need for approval underscores the importance of fiscal responsibility and strategic planning in travel decisions.

A prevalent misunderstanding is that employees may overlook the necessity for approval when booking travel on short notice, assuming it is permissible. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies regarding travel exceptions and changes, highlighting the importance of adhering to established procedures to avoid unnecessary costs. Employees should be mindful of the broader context of the travel policy to ensure compliance and effective management of travel resources.

### **AIR-3.2 - Changes and cancellations**

Change and cancellation fees are reimbursable only where the change was required by the business and is evidenced by the travel record.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify the conditions under which change and cancellation fees can be reimbursed, emphasizing that such expenses must be justified by business necessity. This provision aims to protect the company from incurring unnecessary costs while allowing for flexibility in travel arrangements when required by business needs. Typical situations include last-minute changes to travel plans due to unforeseen business developments or client requirements, where documentation is essential to support reimbursement requests.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume all change and cancellation fees are reimbursable without understanding the necessity for business justification. This clause is closely related to policies governing travel approvals and documentation requirements, underscoring the importance of maintaining thorough records to substantiate claims. Employees are advised to familiarize themselves with the full scope of travel policies to ensure they understand the criteria for reimbursement.

### **AIR-4.1 - Rail**

Rail travel follows the regional addendum. Where the addendum is silent, the standard class of service applies and a higher class requires approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the framework for rail travel, indicating that the regional addendum will govern travel arrangements unless otherwise specified. The intent is to ensure consistency and clarity in travel class selection while allowing for flexibility based on regional considerations. Typical business situations include domestic and regional travel where rail is a viable alternative to air travel, ensuring that employees have access to appropriate and cost-effective transportation options.

A common misconception is that employees may not be aware of the regional addendum or its implications, leading to potential non-compliance with travel class requirements. This clause is conceptually related to other travel policies that address class of service and approval processes, emphasizing the need for employees to understand the specific guidelines applicable to their travel arrangements. Familiarity with the regional addendum and the overall travel policy is crucial for ensuring adherence to corporate travel standards.

# Ground Transportation Policy

Document ID Do6 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category transport

## GRD-1.1 - Business ground transport

Taxi and ride-hailing are reimbursable for travel between business locations, an airport, a hotel, a client site or an approved event. The claim must state the origin and the destination.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to outline the circumstances under which expenses for taxi and ride-hailing services may be reimbursed. It is designed to facilitate efficient travel between various business-related locations, such as offices, airports, hotels, client sites, or approved events. By specifying the need for a clear origin and destination on claims, the policy ensures that expenses are directly linked to legitimate business activities, thereby promoting accountability and transparency in the reimbursement process.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that all travel expenses incurred during business trips are automatically reimbursable. However, the policy explicitly limits reimbursement to specific types of transport and locations. This clause is conceptually related to others, such as those regarding private vehicle mileage and late-night travel, as they collectively establish a framework for understanding what constitutes reimbursable travel expenses and the documentation required to support such claims.

## GRD-1.2 - Commuting

Ordinary travel between home and the usual place of work is a commute and is not reimbursable, except under the late-night rule.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clearly delineate the boundaries of reimbursable travel expenses, specifically addressing the distinction between commuting and business travel. Ordinary travel from home to the usual workplace is classified as a commute and is not eligible for reimbursement, which helps to manage the company's financial resources effectively. The exception for late-night travel recognizes that employees may incur additional costs due to extended work hours, thereby providing a measure of support for those situations.

A common misconception is that any travel related to work, including daily commutes, should be reimbursed. However, the policy intends to limit reimbursement to actual business-related travel, thus preventing potential abuse of the reimbursement system. This clause is closely related to the late-night travel policy, as it highlights the specific circumstances under which commuting may be reimbursed, ensuring that employees understand the conditions that apply to different types of travel expenses.

## GRD-2.1 - Late-night travel

Home transport departing after 22:00 is reimbursable where documented business activity ended after 21:30. The claim must state the route and the activity that ended late.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause is designed to provide clarity regarding the reimbursement of home transport costs incurred after standard business hours. By stipulating that reimbursement is only available when documented business activities extend beyond a specified time, the policy aims to support employees who may need to travel home late due to work commitments. This provision recognizes the challenges of balancing work demands with personal time, ensuring that employees are not financially penalized for fulfilling their professional responsibilities.

A frequent misunderstanding is that any late-night travel should automatically qualify for reimbursement, regardless of the circumstances. However, the policy requires that the business activity must have concluded after a specified time to be eligible for reimbursement. This clause connects with the commuting policy, as it highlights the distinction between regular travel and exceptional circumstances, ensuring employees are aware of the specific conditions under which late-night travel expenses can be claimed.

## GRD-3.1 - Car rental

Car rental requires manager approval and is available to grade G4 and above.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the requirements for renting a vehicle for business purposes, emphasizing the necessity of managerial approval and the eligibility criteria based on employee grade. This ensures that car rental expenses are controlled and only incurred when deemed necessary for business operations. By limiting this benefit to certain grades, the policy aims to manage costs while still providing essential resources for employees who require transportation for work-related activities.

A common misconception is that all employees can independently rent vehicles for business purposes without prior approval. However, the requirement for managerial consent is crucial to ensure that such expenses are justified and align with the company's financial policies. This clause is related to other transportation policies, such as those regarding taxi reimbursements and private vehicle mileage, as they collectively form a comprehensive framework for understanding the company's approach to travel-related expenses.

#### **GRD-4.1 - Private vehicle mileage**

Use of a private vehicle is reimbursed at the per-kilometre rate published in the regional addendum multiplied by the distance stated on the claim. A claim for more than the calculated amount cannot be approved as submitted.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the reimbursement policy for employees who utilize their private vehicles for business-related travel. By specifying that reimbursement is calculated based on a per-kilometre rate, the policy ensures that employees are compensated fairly for the costs incurred while using their personal vehicles for work purposes. This approach promotes accountability and ensures that claims are substantiated by actual travel distances, thereby protecting the company's financial interests.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may claim any amount they wish for private vehicle use without adhering to the established calculation method. However, the policy explicitly states that claims exceeding the calculated amount will not be approved, reinforcing the importance of accurate reporting. This clause is conceptually related to other travel reimbursement policies, such as those for taxi services and parking expenses, as they collectively define the parameters for acceptable travel-related claims.

#### **GRD-5.1 - Parking and tolls**

Parking and tolls are reimbursable when incurred on business travel and evidenced by a receipt naming the location.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the conditions under which expenses for parking and tolls incurred during business travel are eligible for reimbursement. By requiring that these expenses be substantiated with a receipt that identifies the location, the policy promotes transparency and accountability in the reimbursement process. This ensures that employees are reimbursed for necessary costs directly related to business activities while discouraging any potential misuse of the reimbursement system.

A common misunderstanding is that all parking and toll expenses are automatically reimbursable regardless of their relevance to business activities. However, the policy specifies that only those incurred during business travel and supported by appropriate documentation will be reimbursed. This clause is related to other travel expense policies, such as those for taxi and private vehicle use, as they collectively establish the framework for what constitutes legitimate business-related travel expenses.

# Meals and Entertainment Policy

Document ID D07 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category meals

## MEAL-1.1 - Employee meals

A meal consumed only by employees during ordinary work is reimbursable up to the per-person employee meal ceiling in the regional addendum and requires a business reason beyond routine attendance. The ceiling is applied to the total divided by the number of attendees.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish guidelines for the reimbursement of meals consumed solely by employees during regular work hours. This provision is particularly relevant in situations where employees engage in business meetings or discussions over meals, which may enhance productivity and collaboration. It is designed to ensure that the company supports its workforce while maintaining fiscal responsibility. The requirement for a business reason beyond routine attendance emphasizes the need for meals to serve a specific business purpose rather than merely providing sustenance during work hours.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause may arise from the interpretation of what constitutes a 'business reason.' Employees might assume that any meal taken during work hours qualifies for reimbursement, but the clause clearly stipulates that there must be a defined business purpose. This topic is conceptually linked to the broader expense policy, particularly in relation to client meals and business entertainment, where similar principles of purpose and attendee classification apply, ensuring a consistent approach to reimbursement across different types of meals.

## MEAL-1.2 - Client meals

A meal with at least one external attendee is a client meal. The claim must name the external attendees or their organisations and the business purpose. Per-attendee spend is the total divided by all attendees present, including employees, and is compared with the regional client meal ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the criteria for classifying meals that include external attendees as client meals. It is particularly pertinent in scenarios where employees engage with clients or business partners over meals to foster relationships or discuss business matters. By requiring the identification of external attendees and the business purpose of the meal, the policy aims to ensure that expenditures are justifiable and aligned with the company's objectives. This structure not only promotes transparency but also encourages employees to be intentional in their client interactions.

A common misconception surrounding this clause is the belief that any meal with external attendees is automatically reimbursable without further justification. However, the requirement to specify attendees and the business purpose is crucial for compliance and accountability. This clause is closely related to the employee meals policy, as both deal with meal reimbursements but differ in terms of attendee classification and the associated ceilings, reinforcing the need for clarity in expense claims.

## MEAL-1.3 - Business entertainment

External entertainment that is primarily recreational is tested against the per-external-attendee entertainment ceiling in the regional addendum, not the client meal ceiling, and requires manager approval above the approval threshold for entertainment.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the parameters for reimbursing expenses related to external entertainment that is primarily recreational in nature. This is relevant in situations where employees host clients or partners in a social setting, aiming to strengthen business relationships. By specifying that such entertainment must adhere to a separate ceiling and requires manager approval, the clause ensures that expenditures are appropriate and aligned with the company's strategic goals while maintaining fiscal oversight.

Common misunderstandings may arise from the interpretation of what constitutes 'primarily recreational' entertainment. Employees might mistakenly believe that any social gathering qualifies for reimbursement, but the clause emphasizes the need for a clear distinction between business-related meals and entertainment. This topic is conceptually linked to client meals and employee meals, as all these categories involve external interactions but are governed by different reimbursement criteria and approval processes, highlighting the importance of adhering to the specific guidelines for each type.

## MEAL-2.1 - Alcohol

Alcohol follows the regional addendum. Where permitted, it must be incidental to an otherwise reimbursable client meal or event and its share of the bill is limited as the addendum states.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause governs the reimbursement of alcohol expenses, stipulating that such costs must be incidental to a reimbursable client meal or event. This is particularly relevant in contexts where alcohol is served during business meetings or client dinners, providing an opportunity for relationship-building in a more relaxed atmosphere. By aligning alcohol expenses with the overall meal or event reimbursement, the policy aims to ensure that these costs are reasonable and justifiable within the broader context of business expenditures.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that alcohol can be reimbursed independently of the meal or event. However, the clause clearly states that alcohol must be incidental, which reinforces the need for it to be part of a larger business purpose. This topic is related to the broader categories of client meals and business entertainment, as all these areas involve considerations of appropriateness and justification for expenses, emphasizing the importance of maintaining a clear connection between the type of expense and its business relevance.

## **MEAL-2.2 - Tips and service charges**

Mandatory service charges are reimbursable. A voluntary gratuity above 15 percent of the pre-tip bill requires manager approval unless the regional addendum is stricter.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the reimbursement of tips and service charges associated with meals and events. It is particularly relevant in situations where employees dine at restaurants or venues that include mandatory service charges or where gratuities are customary. By allowing reimbursement of mandatory charges while requiring approval for voluntary gratuities above a specified threshold, the policy seeks to balance employee discretion with fiscal responsibility, ensuring that expenses remain reasonable and justifiable.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the distinction between mandatory service charges and voluntary gratuities. Employees might believe that all tips are reimbursable without consideration of the circumstances, but the clause makes it clear that only mandatory charges qualify without additional approval. This topic is closely related to other meal-related policies, such as those governing client meals and employee meals, as they all require a thoughtful approach to expense claims, ensuring that reimbursements reflect the company's commitment to responsible spending.

## **MEAL-3.1 - Default ceilings for locations without an addendum**

For a country with no regional addendum the employee meal ceiling is SGD 60 per person and the client meal ceiling is SGD 110 per attendee. These defaults never apply to Singapore, India or Japan.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes default ceilings for meal reimbursements in locations without a regional addendum, providing a baseline for employee and client meal expenditures. It is particularly relevant in situations where employees travel to countries lacking specific guidelines, ensuring that there is a clear standard for reimbursement. By defining these defaults, the policy aims to facilitate consistent expense management across diverse geographical locations while maintaining a focus on fiscal responsibility.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the belief that these default ceilings apply universally, regardless of the specific regional context. However, the clause explicitly states that they do not apply to certain countries, which is crucial for compliance. This topic is conceptually linked to the broader expense policy framework, particularly in relation to regional addendums and the varying reimbursement standards that may exist, highlighting the importance of understanding the specific guidelines applicable to each location.

## **MEAL-3.2 - Attendee evidence**

If the attendee count is needed for a per-person test and cannot be established from the claim, the reviewer requests it.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure that the necessary attendee count is accurately established when evaluating claims related to meals. This is particularly relevant in situations where the reimbursement is contingent upon a per-person test, such as when determining the appropriateness of meal expenses for group events. By requiring the reviewer to request attendee evidence when it is not provided, the policy aims to maintain transparency and accountability in expense reporting, ensuring that claims are substantiated with clear documentation.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that any claim can be approved without sufficient evidence of attendee counts. Some may believe that the burden of proof lies solely with the claimant, whereas the policy clearly delineates the reviewer's responsibility to seek clarification when necessary. This clause is conceptually linked to neighboring policies concerning documentation and expense verification, highlighting the importance of accurate record-keeping and the role of reviewers in maintaining compliance with the overall expense policy.

#### **MEAL-4.1 - Mixed-purpose events**

Where an event combines employee-only and external activity and the allocation is unclear, the reviewer requests clarification instead of choosing the more generous ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the treatment of mixed-purpose events, where both employee and external activities occur. It is essential in situations where the allocation of expenses between these two categories is ambiguous, as it prevents the reviewer from making assumptions that could lead to inappropriate reimbursements. By requiring clarification instead of defaulting to more generous allowances, the policy promotes fairness and ensures that expenses are allocated correctly according to their intended purpose.

A frequent misconception is that reviewers can arbitrarily decide on the allocation of expenses based on their discretion. This can lead to inconsistencies in how similar events are treated. This clause is closely related to the principles of expense justification and proper allocation found in other sections of the policy, reinforcing the need for clear communication and documentation when expenses involve multiple purposes to avoid potential conflicts of interest.

#### **MEAL-5.1 - Meals during conferences**

Meals included in a conference fee cannot also be claimed separately. Where inclusion is unclear the reviewer requests the conference programme.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to prevent double-dipping in expense claims related to meals during conferences. It addresses scenarios where meals are included in the conference fee, thus ensuring that employees do not claim reimbursement for these meals separately. This policy is vital for maintaining fiscal responsibility and integrity in expense reporting, as it encourages employees to be mindful of what has already been covered by the conference registration, thereby avoiding unnecessary expenditures.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may believe they can claim separate meal expenses if they are unsure about the inclusion of meals in the conference fee. This could lead to confusion and potential violations of the policy. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies regarding reimbursement eligibility and documentation requirements, emphasizing the importance of clarity in expense claims and the need for employees to verify what is included in their conference fees before submitting claims.

# Client Gifts and Hospitality Policy

Document ID Do8 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category gifts

## GIFT-1.1 - Purpose

Modest gifts to external business contacts are reimbursable where they support an existing business relationship and are neither lavish nor intended to influence a decision improperly.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to outline the conditions under which modest gifts to external business contacts may be reimbursed. It is particularly relevant in situations where maintaining or enhancing business relationships is essential for the company's operations. By setting parameters around the appropriateness of gifts, the policy aims to ensure that they are neither extravagant nor intended to improperly influence decisions, thereby safeguarding the company's reputation and ethical standards.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding what constitutes a 'modest' gift, leading some to believe that any gift, regardless of value, may be acceptable. This clause is interconnected with other policies on ethical behavior and compliance, emphasizing the need for employees to exercise discretion and sound judgment when engaging in gift-giving practices. Clarity in this area helps prevent potential conflicts of interest and reinforces the importance of maintaining professional integrity in business relationships.

## GIFT-1.2 - Prohibited recipients

A gift to a public official, a government-affiliated body or a person who is a decision-maker in an open tender involving the company is prohibited and is rejected regardless of value.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to explicitly prohibit the giving of gifts to certain recipients, including public officials and individuals involved in decision-making processes related to open tenders. This is crucial in maintaining compliance with legal and ethical standards, as it helps to prevent any appearance of impropriety or undue influence. By clearly defining prohibited recipients, the policy safeguards the company against potential legal repercussions and promotes ethical conduct in all business dealings.

A common misunderstanding is that gifts can be given to any recipient as long as they are deemed modest. This clause clarifies that specific individuals and entities are off-limits, regardless of the gift's value. This policy is closely related to other sections concerning compliance and ethical standards, highlighting the importance of understanding the broader implications of gift-giving practices and ensuring that all employees are aware of the restrictions in place to protect the company's integrity.

## GIFT-1.3 - Cash and equivalents

Cash, gift cards, vouchers and other cash equivalents are prohibited as gifts and are rejected.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to prohibit the reimbursement of cash, gift cards, vouchers, and other cash equivalents as gifts. This is essential for maintaining ethical standards and preventing any potential misuse of funds that could arise from the ambiguity surrounding cash-like gifts. By establishing this prohibition, the policy aims to promote transparency and accountability in business practices, ensuring that gifts are tangible and appropriate in nature.

A common misunderstanding may be the belief that cash equivalents can be considered acceptable gifts if they are modest in value. However, this clause clearly delineates that all forms of cash equivalents are prohibited, regardless of their perceived value. This policy is conceptually linked to the broader principles of ethical gifting and compliance, emphasizing the need for clarity and consistency in gift-giving practices to uphold the company's standards and avoid any potential conflicts of interest.

## GIFT-1.4 - Required details

A gift claim must state the recipient name, the recipient organisation and the business purpose. A claim missing any of them is returned for the missing details.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure that all gift claims are substantiated with essential information that validates the business intent behind the gift. By requiring the recipient's name, the recipient's organization, and the business purpose, the company aims to maintain transparency and accountability in its gifting practices. This clause is particularly relevant in situations where employees are recognizing clients, partners, or other stakeholders through gifts, as it helps to ensure that such gestures align with the company's values and compliance requirements.

A common misunderstanding is that the requirement for details is merely administrative, when in fact, it serves a critical role in preventing potential ethical issues related to gifting. Employees may confuse gifts with

other forms of business entertainment, which are governed by different policies. This clause is conceptually linked to the Meals and Entertainment Policy, as both deal with the appropriateness of expenditures aimed at fostering business relationships, but they are distinct in their definitions and requirements.

### **GIFT-2.1 - Per-gift ceiling**

The value of a single gift to one recipient may not exceed the per-gift ceiling in the regional addendum for the transaction date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes a limit on the value of gifts that can be given to a single recipient, thereby promoting responsible and ethical gifting practices within the organization. By adhering to the specified ceiling, employees can ensure that their gift-giving does not create undue influence or perceptions of favoritism. This clause is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees are engaging with clients or partners, as it sets a clear boundary for acceptable gift values that align with the company's ethical standards and compliance protocols.

A frequent misconception is that the ceiling applies uniformly across all contexts, while it actually varies by region and is specified in an addendum. Employees may also confuse this clause with the annual ceiling on gifts to the same recipient organization, which addresses cumulative gifting over a longer period. Understanding this clause in relation to the annual ceiling is crucial, as both aim to regulate gifting practices but do so in different temporal contexts.

### **GIFT-2.2 - Annual ceiling**

The total of gifts to the same recipient organisation in a calendar year, including the current claim, may not exceed the annual ceiling in the regional addendum. Earlier gifts are found in the previous expense records.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to limit the total value of gifts given to the same recipient organization within a calendar year, thus ensuring that the company's gifting practices remain within ethical boundaries over time. By establishing an annual ceiling, the company seeks to prevent any potential perception of impropriety that may arise from excessive gifting. This clause is particularly relevant in ongoing business relationships where multiple gifts may be offered throughout the year, ensuring that the total value remains reasonable and justifiable.

A common misunderstanding is that the annual ceiling applies only to the current claim, whereas it encompasses all gifts made to the same organization within the specified timeframe. Employees may also confuse this clause with the per-gift ceiling, which governs individual gift values. It is important to recognize that both clauses work together to create a comprehensive framework for managing gifting practices, with one focusing on individual transactions and the other on cumulative totals.

### **GIFT-3.1 - Hospitality distinguished**

A shared meal is governed by the Meals and Entertainment Policy. A gift is an item given to a recipient to keep.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to distinguish between gifts and hospitality, clarifying the nature of each expenditure type within the corporate context. By defining a gift as an item given to a recipient to keep, the company aims to ensure that employees understand the appropriate categorization of their expenses. This distinction is crucial in maintaining compliance with various policies, particularly when engaging in client relations or partnership activities where both gifts and meals may be involved.

A common misunderstanding is that gifts and shared meals can be treated interchangeably, leading to potential misclassification of expenses. Employees may overlook the specific guidelines outlined in the Meals and Entertainment Policy, which governs shared meals, while failing to recognize that gifts have distinct implications for reporting and compliance. Understanding this clause in relation to the Meals and Entertainment Policy is essential for accurate expense reporting and adherence to corporate governance.

# Corporate Card and Personal Spend Policy

Document ID D09 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category card

## CARD-1.1 - Personal spend

Purely personal purchases are not reimbursable even when paid with a corporate card.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the boundaries of reimbursable expenses, explicitly stating that personal purchases made with a corporate card are not eligible for reimbursement. This policy is essential for maintaining fiscal responsibility and ensuring that corporate resources are used solely for business-related expenses. It is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees may inadvertently use corporate funds for personal items, as it reinforces the expectation of separating personal and professional financial transactions.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may believe that any purchase made with a corporate card, regardless of its nature, could be reimbursed under certain circumstances. This misconception can lead to confusion and potential misuse of corporate resources. The clause is conceptually related to the accidental personal use policy, which addresses instances where personal purchases occur unintentionally, but this clause sets a clear prohibition on personal spending regardless of intent.

## CARD-1.2 - Accidental personal use

An accidental personal purchase on a corporate card is rejected for reimbursement and handled by the repayment process outside expense review.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the handling of accidental personal purchases made on a corporate card, outlining that such transactions are not eligible for reimbursement and must be managed through a repayment process. This policy is designed to protect the integrity of corporate funds while providing a clear protocol for employees who may inadvertently make personal purchases. It is particularly relevant in situations where employees may mix personal and business expenses, emphasizing the need for vigilance in expense management.

A common misunderstanding is that accidental personal purchases could be reimbursed if they are reported promptly, which is not the case according to this clause. Employees may also confuse this policy with the prohibition on personal spending, not recognizing that this clause specifically addresses unintentional errors. Understanding the distinction between intentional personal purchases and accidental use is vital for compliance with corporate policies and maintaining accurate financial records.

## CARD-2.1 - Consumer services

Streaming, gaming, personal fitness, household utilities and other consumer services are presumed personal unless a category policy names the specific business use.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the types of consumer services that are generally considered personal expenses. In typical business situations, employees may encounter scenarios where they seek reimbursement for expenses related to streaming services, gaming subscriptions, personal fitness memberships, and household utilities. This clause serves as a guideline to help employees understand that unless explicitly stated in a category policy, such expenses are not reimbursable and should be classified as personal.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that all consumer services can be justified as business-related if they are used for work purposes. However, the clause clearly indicates that only those services explicitly named in a category policy can be deemed acceptable for reimbursement. This topic is closely related to the broader expense classification policies, as it emphasizes the importance of understanding what constitutes a personal versus a business expense, thereby aiding in compliance with the overall expense management framework.

## CARD-3.1 - Merchant risk classes

Each merchant in the merchant directory carries a risk class. STANDARD merchants are ordinary. RESTRICTED\_PROHIBITED merchants, such as casinos and adult entertainment venues, are not reimbursable and the claim is rejected. RESTRICTED\_REVIEW merchants, such as prepaid-card resellers, require Finance review and the claim is escalated.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the classification of merchants within the company's merchant directory, which is essential for determining the reimbursement eligibility of expenses incurred at

various establishments. In typical business situations, employees may encounter a wide range of merchants when making purchases for company-related activities. The risk class assigned to each merchant helps to streamline the review process for expense claims and ensures that employees are aware of which merchants fall under standard, restricted, or prohibited categories.

A common misunderstanding about this clause is the belief that all merchants can be reimbursed as long as they are used for business purposes. However, the clause specifies that certain merchants, particularly those classified as restricted or prohibited, will not be reimbursed. This classification is conceptually linked to the broader topic of expense approval processes, as it underscores the necessity of adhering to established merchant guidelines to avoid potential claim rejections and maintain compliance with the company's risk management policies.

#### **CARD-4.1 - Merchant lookup**

The merchant risk class is taken from the merchant directory, not from the merchant name as typed on the claim.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify that the merchant risk class is determined by the official merchant directory rather than the name entered by the employee on the expense claim. This is particularly important in business situations where employees may inadvertently misclassify merchants due to typographical errors or misunderstandings of merchant names. By reinforcing the reliance on the merchant directory, this clause aims to promote consistency and accuracy in the expense reimbursement process.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the assumption that the name of the merchant as typed on the claim is sufficient for determining reimbursement eligibility. Employees may mistakenly believe that they can override or ignore the merchant directory's classifications. This topic relates to the broader expense management policies, as it highlights the importance of utilizing official resources and maintaining accurate records to ensure compliance and facilitate smoother reimbursement processes.

# Approval Authority, Delegation and Budget Control Policy

Document ID D10 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category approval

## APR-1.1 - Manager approval

A single discretionary expense above SGD 500 equivalent requires manager approval. The regional addenda may set a lower local threshold, which then controls.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the requirement for manager approval for discretionary expenses that exceed a specified threshold. This clause is particularly relevant in business situations where employees may incur significant expenses that require oversight to ensure that spending aligns with company policies and budgetary constraints. By mandating manager approval, the company aims to promote fiscal responsibility and accountability within its expense management framework.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that all expenses require manager approval, regardless of their nature or amount. However, the clause specifically applies to discretionary expenses above a certain threshold, indicating that not all transactions necessitate managerial oversight. This topic is conceptually related to other approval processes within the expense policy, as it emphasizes the need for a structured review mechanism to maintain control over company expenditures while allowing for flexibility in lower-value transactions.

## APR-1.2 - Director approval

A single discretionary expense above SGD 1,500 equivalent requires director approval for transactions dated in 2024 and 2025, and above SGD 2,000 equivalent for transactions dated in 2026.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the requirement for director approval for discretionary expenses that exceed a specified threshold, particularly for transactions occurring in designated years. This is essential in business situations where employees may need to make larger purchases that could significantly impact the company's financial standing. By requiring director approval, the company ensures that higher-value expenditures are scrutinized and justified, thereby promoting responsible spending practices.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that director approval is required for all discretionary expenses, regardless of their amount or timing. In reality, this clause delineates specific thresholds that trigger the need for such approval. This topic is closely related to the broader approval processes outlined in the expense policy, as it highlights the importance of tiered oversight based on the value and timing of expenses, ensuring that appropriate levels of management are involved in significant financial decisions.

## APR-1.3 - Finance review

A single discretionary expense above SGD 5,000 equivalent requires Finance review and is escalated. An exception to a prohibited category or a conflict between an approval and the transaction facts also requires Finance review.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to stipulate that discretionary expenses exceeding a specified threshold require Finance review, which serves to ensure that such expenses are in compliance with company policies and financial guidelines. This is particularly relevant in business situations where employees may submit claims for substantial expenditures that necessitate additional scrutiny. By involving the Finance department, the company aims to mitigate financial risks and ensure that all claims are valid and justifiable.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that Finance review is only necessary for exceptionally high-value expenses. However, the clause also indicates that exceptions to prohibited categories or conflicts between approvals and transaction facts will also trigger a Finance review. This topic is conceptually linked to the overall expense approval hierarchy, as it reinforces the importance of thorough review processes to uphold financial integrity and compliance across all levels of expense management.

## APR-2.1 - Approval validity

An approval is valid only if its status is APPROVED, it names the employee, its type covers the expense category, it covers the transaction date, and the approver level is at least the level the amount requires. Approval types are GENERAL, TRAVEL, SOFTWARE, ENTERTAINMENT, TRAINING and COMBINED\_SPEND.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the criteria under which an approval for expenses is deemed valid. It outlines the essential components that must be present for an approval to be recognized, including the approval status, the identification of the employee, the relevant expense category, the transaction date, and the appropriate approver level. This clause is particularly pertinent in scenarios where expenses are being submitted for reimbursement or pre-approval, ensuring that all necessary checks are in place to maintain financial integrity and compliance within the organization.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that any form of approval is sufficient, regardless of its completeness or relevance to the specific expense. This misconception can lead to complications in the expense approval process, as approvals that do not meet the outlined criteria may result in delays or rejections. This clause is closely related to the approval scope, as both emphasize the importance of specificity in approvals, ensuring that each approval is tailored to the unique circumstances of the expense in question.

## **APR-2.2 - Approval scope**

An approval cannot be reused for another employee, another category or another date range unless it says so. An approval whose type does not cover the expense is treated as conflicting evidence.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the limitations on the reuse of approvals, emphasizing that each approval is specific to an employee, expense category, and date range unless explicitly stated otherwise. This specificity is crucial in maintaining accountability and traceability within the expense management process. It is particularly relevant in situations where multiple employees may incur similar expenses or when expenses are submitted over a period of time, ensuring that each approval is appropriately linked to its corresponding transaction.

A frequent misconception is that approvals can be generically applied across different employees or expense categories, which can result in compliance issues and financial discrepancies. Understanding this clause is essential, as it relates to the approval validity, reinforcing the need for each approval to be distinctly applicable to its designated context. This interconnectedness ensures that the approval process is both rigorous and transparent, safeguarding the organization against potential misuse of approvals.

## **APR-3.1 - Missing approval**

Where an approval is required and no valid approval record exists, the reviewer requests it from the employee. Where the amount requires Finance review, or the approval evidence conflicts, the claim is escalated instead.

**Interpretive guidance.** The intent of this clause is to outline the procedure to follow when an approval is required but not present. It emphasizes the responsibility of the reviewer to request the necessary approval from the employee, thereby ensuring that all expenses are properly authorized before processing. This clause is particularly relevant in scenarios where expenses are submitted without prior approval, underscoring the importance of compliance with the organization's expense policy and maintaining financial oversight.

One common misunderstanding is that expenses can be processed without any form of approval, leading to potential financial irregularities. This clause is crucial in differentiating between valid and invalid claims, as it establishes a clear protocol for handling missing approvals. It is conceptually linked to the invalid delegation clause, as both address situations where proper authorization is lacking, highlighting the need for rigorous adherence to approval processes to ensure fiscal responsibility.

## **APR-4.1 - Delegation**

A manager who is unavailable may delegate approval authority. The approval record then has the status DELEGATED and references a delegation record. The delegation is valid only on dates inside its validity period and only for amounts up to its stated SGD limit, and the delegate must hold the approver level the amount requires.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the conditions under which a manager may delegate their approval authority in instances of unavailability. It specifies that the delegation must be documented and that the delegated authority is bound by certain parameters, including validity periods and approver levels. This provision is particularly useful in maintaining continuity in the approval process, ensuring that expenses can still be authorized in the absence of the primary approver, thereby facilitating timely processing of claims.

A common misunderstanding is that delegation can occur without adherence to the specified conditions, which may lead to unauthorized approvals or financial discrepancies. This clause is closely related to the invalid delegation clause, as both address the importance of maintaining the integrity of the approval process

through proper delegation practices. Understanding the nuances of delegation is essential for managers to ensure compliance and uphold the standards set forth in the expense policy.

#### **APR-4.2 - Invalid delegation**

If the delegation is outside its validity period, the reviewer requests a valid approval. If the delegation is valid but the amount exceeds its limit or the delegate holds a lower level than the amount requires, the claim is escalated.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the protocol for handling invalid delegations of approval authority. It outlines the actions that must be taken when a delegation falls outside its validity period or does not meet the necessary criteria, such as exceeding the stated limit or involving a delegate with a lower approver level. This clause is critical in ensuring that the delegation process remains robust and that all approvals are valid and compliant with the organization's policies.

A common misconception is that any delegated approval is automatically valid, regardless of compliance with the established criteria. This misunderstanding can lead to unauthorized claims being processed, which may result in financial discrepancies. This clause is conceptually linked to the delegation clause, as both emphasize the importance of adhering to the parameters set for delegation. Together, they ensure that the approval process remains transparent and accountable, safeguarding the organization's financial integrity.

#### **APR-5.1 - Cost-centre budget**

Where a claim is charged to a cost centre whose status is FROZEN, any expense above SGD 200 equivalent is escalated to Finance. Where the remaining budget of an OPEN cost centre is smaller than the claim amount, the reviewer requests budget-owner approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause is designed to address the implications of charging expenses to cost centres with different statuses, specifically focusing on frozen and open cost centres. It establishes a clear protocol for escalating claims that exceed certain thresholds or when the remaining budget is insufficient. This is particularly important for maintaining budgetary control and ensuring that expenses are managed within the constraints of the organization's financial framework.

A common misunderstanding is that all expenses can be charged to any cost centre without regard for its status, which can lead to budget overruns and financial mismanagement. This clause is closely related to the approval scope, as both highlight the need for careful consideration of the financial implications of expenses. Understanding this clause is essential for employees to navigate the expense submission process effectively, ensuring that all claims are compliant with budgetary guidelines.

#### **APR-5.2 - Project hierarchy**

A project that has a parent project is charged to the cost centre of the parent project. The parent project, if any, is looked up in the project registry.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear framework for the allocation of costs associated with projects that have a hierarchical structure. In typical business scenarios, this clause applies when a project is initiated under the umbrella of a parent project, ensuring that all expenses are accurately charged to the appropriate cost centre. This facilitates effective budget management and financial reporting, as it allows for a consolidated view of project expenditures and resource allocation within the organization. By maintaining this hierarchy, the company can better track the financial performance of both parent and child projects, enabling informed decision-making and strategic planning.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause may arise from confusion about the relationship between parent and child projects. Some employees might assume that costs can be allocated arbitrarily or that they can charge expenses to their own cost centres without regard to the established hierarchy. It is essential to clarify that this clause is closely related to other financial policies, such as budget management and cost allocation, which emphasize the importance of accurate reporting and accountability. Understanding this connection can help employees recognize the significance of adhering to the project hierarchy in maintaining the integrity of financial records.

# Exceptions and Waivers Procedure

Document ID D11 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category exceptions

## EXC-1.1 - What an exception is

An exception is a written waiver approved in advance that permits a stated departure from a stated policy for a stated employee and date range. It is recorded in the exception register with an identifier.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to define what constitutes an exception within the context of the company's policies. It highlights the necessity for a written waiver that must be approved in advance, thereby ensuring that any deviations from established policies are formally recognized and documented. This is particularly relevant in situations where an employee encounters unique circumstances that necessitate a departure from standard policy, such as unforeseen travel expenses or specific project-related costs. By requiring prior approval, the company safeguards against arbitrary deviations and promotes accountability in financial practices.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the belief that verbal agreements or informal approvals can serve as valid exceptions. It is crucial to emphasize that only written waivers that have received formal approval are recognized as exceptions. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies regarding compliance and governance, as it underscores the importance of adhering to established protocols while also providing a mechanism for flexibility when justified. Employees should be aware that exceptions are not a loophole but rather a structured process to address specific needs within the framework of the company's policies.

## EXC-1.2 - Scope

An exception is valid only if its status is APPROVED, it names the employee, its policy identifier is the policy being departed from, and the transaction date lies inside its validity dates.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the specific conditions under which an exception is considered valid. It stipulates that an exception must have an APPROVED status, clearly identify the employee involved, reference the policy being deviated from, and fall within designated transaction dates. This clarity is essential in business situations where employees may seek to navigate policy constraints due to unique circumstances. By establishing these criteria, the company ensures that exceptions are not only justified but also traceable, thereby maintaining the integrity of the policy framework.

A frequent misunderstanding of this clause may involve the assumption that any written request for an exception is sufficient for approval. It is important to clarify that without meeting the outlined criteria, an exception cannot be deemed valid. This clause relates closely to the broader context of policy compliance and governance, as it reinforces the need for adherence to established protocols while allowing for necessary flexibility. Employees should understand that the exception process is designed to balance operational needs with the overarching goal of maintaining policy integrity.

## EXC-2.1 - Outcomes

If a cited exception is valid, the departure it permits is accepted. If it is not APPROVED or the transaction date lies outside its validity dates, the departure is not permitted and the claim is decided under the ordinary rule. If it names a different policy or employee, the claim is escalated to Finance. If the cited identifier does not exist, the reviewer requests the correct reference.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the consequences of citing an exception in relation to policy departures. It specifies that if an exception is valid, the permitted departure will be accepted; however, if it fails to meet the necessary criteria, the claim will revert to standard policy rules. This is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees may have incurred expenses that deviate from established guidelines due to special circumstances. The clause ensures that there is a clear process for evaluating the legitimacy of exceptions, thereby promoting fairness and consistency in the handling of claims.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the interpretation of what constitutes a valid exception. Some employees might believe that any reference to an exception automatically grants approval, which is not the case. This clause is conceptually linked to the principles of accountability and compliance, emphasizing that exceptions must be rigorously vetted. Employees should recognize that the exception process is not a blanket allowance but a carefully regulated mechanism designed to ensure that all claims are evaluated fairly and in accordance with established policies.

## EXC-2.2 - Where the identifier comes from

The exception identifier may be quoted on the claim, or may be linked from the travel request record. A linked identifier is looked up in the exception register.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify the origin and usage of the exception identifier within the claims process. It indicates that the identifier may either be quoted directly on the claim or linked from the travel request record, with the latter requiring verification against the exception register. This is particularly relevant in business situations where employees are submitting claims that involve exceptions, as it ensures that all necessary documentation is accurately referenced. By establishing a clear protocol for identifying exceptions, the company enhances the efficiency and accuracy of the claims review process.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that the exception identifier is optional or can be substituted with other forms of reference. It is crucial to emphasize that the identifier is a mandatory component of the claims process and must be accurately linked or quoted. This clause is closely related to other policies regarding documentation and record-keeping, as it underscores the importance of maintaining precise records to facilitate effective claims processing. Employees should understand that proper referencing of exception identifiers is essential for ensuring compliance and accountability in financial transactions.

### **EXC-3.1 - No exception for prohibitions**

No exception can permit a prohibited category, a prohibited recipient or a prohibited merchant class.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to explicitly state that no exceptions can be granted for certain prohibited categories, recipients, or merchant classes. This provision is essential for maintaining the integrity of the company's financial policies and ensuring that all expenditures align with ethical and legal standards. In typical business scenarios, this clause applies when employees seek to claim expenses that fall within these prohibited areas, thereby protecting the organization from potential risks associated with non-compliant spending. By clearly delineating these prohibitions, the company reinforces its commitment to responsible financial management.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the belief that exceptions can be made in cases of urgency or necessity, even within prohibited categories. It is important to clarify that this clause is absolute and does not allow for any deviations in these specific instances. This provision is conceptually linked to the broader framework of compliance and risk management policies, as it emphasizes the importance of adhering to established boundaries to safeguard the organization. Employees should recognize that the prohibition of exceptions in these areas is a critical aspect of maintaining the company's ethical standards and financial integrity.

# Training, Certification and Conferences Policy

Document ID D12 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category training

## TRN-1.1 - Conference registration

Conference fees are reimbursable only for approved professional events relevant to the employee role, evidenced by a REGISTERED entry in the conference registry.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the criteria under which conference registration fees may be reimbursed. It is intended to ensure that employees only incur expenses for professional events that are directly relevant to their roles within the organization. This clause typically applies to situations where employees attend industry conferences, seminars, or workshops that enhance their skills and knowledge, thereby contributing to their professional development and the overall objectives of the company.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that any conference attended by an employee is automatically eligible for reimbursement. It is essential to recognize that reimbursement is contingent upon prior approval and the relevance of the event to the employee's role. This clause is conceptually related to the event evidence clause, which further clarifies the documentation required to substantiate claims, thereby reinforcing the need for proper approval processes in expense management.

## TRN-1.2 - Event evidence

The conference registry or the approved travel record establishes event approval. The employee description alone is insufficient where an exception or uplift depends on event status.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to clarify the documentation necessary for establishing the approval of an event prior to incurring expenses. It emphasizes that the conference registry or an approved travel record is essential for validating the legitimacy of the event attended. This is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees may seek reimbursement for costs associated with professional development activities, ensuring that only those events that have been formally recognized by the organization are eligible for reimbursement.

A common misconception is that an employee's role description alone suffices as proof of event relevance for reimbursement claims. However, this clause explicitly states that additional evidence is required to substantiate claims, particularly when exceptions or uplifts are sought. This topic is closely related to the conference registration clause, as both emphasize the importance of prior approval and proper documentation in the expense reimbursement process.

## TRN-2.1 - Annual external training ceilings 2024

The calendar-year ceiling for external training spend per employee, in SGD equivalent, for transactions dated in 2024:

| Grade band | Annual ceiling (SGD) |
|------------|----------------------|
| G1-G3      | 1,800                |
| G4-G5      | 3,200                |
| G6-G7      | 4,800                |
| G8+        | 6,500                |

Spend already reimbursed in the same calendar year counts towards the ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** The intention of this clause is to delineate the annual external training expenditure limits for employees based on their respective grade bands for the specified calendar year. This serves to manage the company's training budget effectively while ensuring that employees have access to professional development opportunities. Typical business situations covered include employees seeking reimbursement for external training courses, workshops, or certifications that contribute to their skill enhancement and career growth.

A prevalent misunderstanding is the belief that these ceilings are flexible or negotiable based on individual circumstances. In reality, these ceilings are established to maintain budgetary discipline and ensure equitable access to training resources across the organization. This clause is conceptually linked to the subsequent clauses regarding annual external training ceilings for subsequent years, highlighting the need for employees to be aware of changing limits and plan their training expenditures accordingly.

## TRN-2.2 - Annual external training ceilings 2025

The calendar-year ceiling for external training spend per employee, in SGD equivalent, for transactions dated in 2025:

| Grade band | Annual ceiling (SGD) |
|------------|----------------------|
| G1-G3      | 2,000                |
| G4-G5      | 3,500                |
| G6-G7      | 5,000                |
| G8+        | 7,000                |

Spend already reimbursed in the same calendar year counts towards the ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the annual external training expenditure limits for employees in the specified calendar year, thereby providing a framework for managing training-related expenses. By establishing clear ceilings based on grade bands, the organization aims to ensure that all employees have equitable access to professional development opportunities while controlling overall training costs. Situations typically addressed include employees planning to enroll in external training programs and seeking reimbursement for associated fees.

A common misconception is that the ceilings are static and do not change over time. Employees may not realize that these limits are reviewed and adjusted annually, reflecting the evolving needs of the organization and the workforce. This clause is conceptually related to the previous clause regarding annual external training ceilings for the prior year, emphasizing the importance of staying informed about current policies to effectively manage training budgets.

### TRN-2.3 - Annual external training ceilings 2026

The calendar-year ceiling for external training spend per employee, in SGD equivalent, for transactions dated in 2026:

| Grade band | Annual ceiling (SGD) |
|------------|----------------------|
| G1-G3      | 2,200                |
| G4-G5      | 3,800                |
| G6-G7      | 5,400                |
| G8+        | 7,500                |

Spend already reimbursed in the same calendar year counts towards the ceiling.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the annual external training expenditure limits for employees for the specified calendar year. By defining these ceilings according to grade bands, the organization seeks to provide a structured approach to employee training and development while ensuring that expenses remain within budgetary constraints. Typical situations covered include employees seeking approval for external training programs and understanding the financial implications of their training choices.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume the limits are applicable indefinitely without regard to the year of the expense. It is crucial for employees to recognize that these ceilings are subject to annual review and adjustment, which may impact their training plans. This clause is conceptually linked to both preceding and subsequent clauses regarding annual external training ceilings, reinforcing the importance of awareness and compliance with current policy limits.

### TRN-2.4 - Learning plan

A training claim must quote the learning plan identifier. A claim without it is returned for the identifier.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to ensure that all training claims are properly documented by requiring the inclusion of a learning plan identifier. This requirement is designed to facilitate the tracking and validation of training expenditures, ensuring that claims align with the organization's training objectives. Typical business situations include employees submitting claims for reimbursement of training expenses and the need for accurate documentation to expedite the approval process.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may believe they can submit claims without the learning plan identifier, assuming that their training expenses will still be processed. However, claims lacking this identifier will be returned, which can lead to delays in reimbursement. This clause is conceptually related to the earlier clauses regarding training ceilings, as both emphasize the importance of proper documentation and adherence to established processes in managing training-related expenses.

### TRN-2.5 - Exceeding the ceiling

Cumulative training spend above the annual ceiling requires director approval of type TRAINING. Without a valid approval the reviewer requests it.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a framework for managing training expenditures that exceed the predetermined annual ceiling. This clause is particularly relevant in scenarios where departments may require additional funding for training initiatives that are deemed essential for employee development. It ensures that any significant investment in training is scrutinized and approved at the director level, thereby promoting accountability and strategic alignment with the organization's overall training objectives.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the interpretation of what constitutes a valid approval and the process for obtaining it. Employees might mistakenly believe that informal verbal approvals are sufficient, whereas formal documentation is required to validate the expenditure. This clause is conceptually linked to other policy topics such as budget management and resource allocation, as it emphasizes the importance of adhering to financial constraints while also fostering employee growth through training.

### **TRN-3.1 - Certification exams**

Professional certification exam fees require manager approval and an active role-development plan, quoted on the claim.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause emphasizes the importance of professional development within the organization by stipulating that fees for certification exams must align with an employee's role-development plan and require managerial approval. It is particularly relevant in situations where employees seek to enhance their skills and competencies through formal certification, reflecting the company's commitment to continuous learning and professional growth. This ensures that the investment in certification aligns with both the employee's career trajectory and the organization's strategic goals.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the necessity of having an active role-development plan in place prior to seeking approval for certification exam fees. Employees might assume that any certification is automatically justified, irrespective of its relevance to their current role or future aspirations. This clause also relates to training and development policies, which may outline broader guidelines for employee education, thereby reinforcing the need for alignment between individual professional goals and organizational objectives.

### **TRN-4.1 - Official partner hotel**

A hotel is an official partner hotel only if it is the partner named in the conference registry entry for the employee.

**Interpretive guidance.** The intent of this clause is to clearly define what qualifies as an official partner hotel for employees attending conferences. This is particularly relevant in travel planning and expense reimbursement scenarios, where employees may seek accommodations that are endorsed by the organization. By specifying that a hotel must be listed in the conference registry to be considered official, the clause aims to streamline travel expenses and ensure compliance with corporate travel policies.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the criteria for selecting accommodations, with employees potentially assuming that any hotel near the conference venue qualifies. This can lead to confusion and non-compliance with the expense policy. This clause is conceptually linked to travel and lodging policies, as it emphasizes the importance of adhering to designated partnerships and agreements to manage costs effectively.

# Software, Subscriptions and Equipment Policy

Document ID D13 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category software

## SWE-1.1 - Subscriptions

A software or online service subscription requires a named business owner on the claim. Up to SGD 500 equivalent no approval is required. Above it, manager approval of type SOFTWARE or GENERAL is required.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish clear guidelines for the approval of software or online service subscriptions, ensuring that each subscription has a designated business owner responsible for its oversight. This is particularly important in situations where subscriptions are essential for daily operations or project execution. By requiring a named business owner, the organization promotes accountability and ensures that resources are allocated effectively, aligning with strategic business objectives.

A common misconception may be that any subscription can be claimed without the need for a business owner, leading to potential misuse or misallocation of resources. Furthermore, this clause intersects with other procurement policies that govern the acquisition of goods and services, highlighting the importance of oversight in managing subscriptions. Understanding the relationship between these policies can enhance compliance and ensure that all subscriptions contribute positively to the organization's operational efficiency.

## SWE-1.2 - Larger subscriptions

From 1 February 2026 a subscription above SGD 1,000 equivalent requires manager approval, an ACTIVE project record and an OPEN cost centre. If the project is not active or the cost centre is not open, the claim is escalated.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the requirements for managing larger software subscriptions, particularly emphasizing the need for managerial approval, an active project record, and an open cost centre. It is designed to ensure that significant financial commitments are justified and linked to ongoing projects, thereby safeguarding the organization's financial resources. This is especially pertinent in scenarios where the subscription is critical to a project's success and requires careful consideration before approval.

A frequent misunderstanding may occur regarding the distinction between general subscriptions and those that fall into this larger category, leading to confusion about the approval process. This clause is closely related to the previous one, as both address subscription management but differ in the scale and associated requirements. Understanding these distinctions is vital for compliance and effective financial management within the organization.

## SWE-1.3 - Prepaid annual plans

A prepaid annual plan above SGD 3,000 equivalent must be procured through Finance and the claim is escalated.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to regulate the procurement process for prepaid annual plans that exceed a defined financial threshold, mandating that such acquisitions be handled through the Finance department. This ensures that the organization maintains control over significant expenditures and that these investments are appropriately vetted. Such a requirement is particularly relevant for large-scale software solutions that can have a substantial impact on operational capabilities and budgetary considerations.

A common misconception may be that all prepaid plans can be procured independently without Finance's involvement, which could lead to potential financial mismanagement. This clause is interconnected with broader procurement and financial policies that govern spending and resource allocation, emphasizing the necessity of centralized oversight for significant financial commitments. Recognizing this relationship helps ensure adherence to organizational standards and promotes fiscal responsibility.

## SWE-2.1 - Equipment

Equipment up to SGD 300 equivalent is reimbursable. Equipment above that and up to SGD 1,000 equivalent requires manager approval. Equipment above SGD 1,000 equivalent is a capital asset and must be procured through Finance; the reimbursement claim is rejected.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the reimbursement framework for equipment expenses, establishing clear thresholds for approval based on the cost of the equipment. It is designed to ensure that employees are aware of the financial parameters within which they can operate when acquiring equipment for business purposes. Typical situations covered under this clause include employees purchasing office supplies,

tools, or technology required for their roles, where the cost of such items falls within specified ranges. The clause also clarifies the distinction between reimbursable expenses and capital assets, thereby streamlining the procurement process and ensuring compliance with financial regulations.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause often arise from confusion about the thresholds for reimbursement and the categorization of equipment versus capital assets. Employees may mistakenly believe that any equipment purchase qualifies for reimbursement, regardless of its cost or intended use. This clause is conceptually related to the procurement policies, as it emphasizes the importance of following established financial procedures for asset acquisition. Additionally, it intersects with the personal devices policy, as it highlights the necessity for equipment to be directly related to business operations to qualify for reimbursement.

## **SWE-2.2 - Personal devices**

Devices primarily for personal use are not reimbursable.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clearly state that devices intended primarily for personal use do not qualify for reimbursement under the corporate expense policy. This distinction is crucial to ensure that company funds are utilized solely for business-related expenses, thereby safeguarding the organization's financial integrity. Typical scenarios covered by this clause include employees seeking reimbursement for personal smartphones, tablets, or other devices that are not essential for their job functions. By setting this boundary, the policy helps to prevent misuse of company resources and promotes responsible spending among employees.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that devices with some business use can be reimbursed, even if they are primarily for personal use. Employees may argue that their personal devices are occasionally used for work purposes, but this does not meet the criteria for reimbursement as outlined in this clause. This topic is closely related to the equipment reimbursement policy, as it reinforces the principle that only purchases directly related to business needs are eligible for reimbursement. Understanding this distinction helps employees navigate the complexities of expense claims and maintain compliance with corporate financial policies.

# Telecommunications Policy

Document ID D14 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category telecom

## TEL-1.1 - Business mobile and data

Business use of a personal mobile plan is reimbursable up to the monthly ceiling in the regional addendum.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the reimbursement policy for business use of personal mobile plans, allowing employees to claim expenses incurred while using their personal devices for work-related communications. The intent is to facilitate effective communication and ensure that employees are not financially burdened when conducting business outside of the company's provided resources. Typical business situations that this clause addresses include employees who need to make calls, send messages, or access data while traveling or working remotely, thereby ensuring that they can perform their duties efficiently without incurring personal costs.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the assumption that all mobile-related expenses are automatically reimbursable, regardless of their nature or purpose. Employees may mistakenly believe that any use of their personal mobile devices for work justifies a claim, but the reimbursement is specifically limited to business use. This clause is conceptually linked to the cumulative monthly claims policy, as it sets the stage for how claims are aggregated and managed within the overall telecommunications expense framework. Understanding the boundaries of this policy helps employees to submit accurate claims and avoid potential rejections.

## TEL-1.2 - Cumulative monthly claims

The monthly ceiling applies to the sum of all telecommunications claims by the employee in the calendar month of the transaction, including the current claim. Earlier claims are found in the previous expense records.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the cumulative claims policy for telecommunications expenses, specifying that the total of all claims submitted by an employee within a calendar month must remain within a defined ceiling. The purpose of this provision is to ensure responsible financial management and prevent excessive claims that could negatively impact the company's budget. Typical situations this clause addresses include employees who submit multiple claims for mobile and data usage throughout the month, ensuring that they are aware of the limits that apply to their total claims and can plan accordingly.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that individual claims can exceed the monthly ceiling as long as they are submitted separately. Employees may not realize that the cumulative total of all claims is what is subject to the ceiling, leading to potential rejections of claims that would collectively exceed the limit. This clause is closely related to the excess claims policy, as it provides the framework for understanding how claims are evaluated in relation to the established ceiling. Familiarity with this policy helps employees manage their expenses effectively and ensures compliance with corporate financial guidelines.

## TEL-2.1 - Excess

A claim that would take the monthly total above the ceiling cannot be approved as submitted.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify that any claim submitted that would result in exceeding the established monthly ceiling for telecommunications expenses cannot be approved as submitted. This provision is essential for maintaining the integrity of the expense management system and ensuring that employees adhere to the financial limits set forth in the policy. Typical business situations covered by this clause include employees who may inadvertently submit claims that, when combined with previous claims, surpass the allowable threshold, thus necessitating a clear understanding of the limits in place.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause often stem from confusion about how the cumulative total is calculated and the implications of exceeding the ceiling. Employees may assume that individual claims can be processed without regard to the overall monthly total, leading to potential issues with claim approval. This clause is conceptually linked to the cumulative monthly claims policy, as it emphasizes the importance of monitoring total claims throughout the month. Awareness of this relationship aids employees in managing their telecommunications expenses responsibly and ensures compliance with corporate policies.

# Duplicate, Split and Recurring Expense Controls

Document ID D15 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category controls

## DUP-1.1 - Exact duplicate

A claim with the same employee, the same merchant and the same bill number as a reimbursed expense, or the same employee, merchant, transaction date and amount, is an exact duplicate and is rejected.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to define what constitutes an exact duplicate claim and establishes the grounds for rejection of such claims. The intent is to prevent the submission of multiple claims for the same expense, thereby safeguarding the company against potential financial discrepancies and ensuring that the reimbursement process remains efficient and transparent. Typical situations covered under this clause include employees who may inadvertently submit duplicate claims for the same expense, either due to oversight or misunderstanding of previous submissions, which could lead to unnecessary complications in the expense approval process.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that minor variations in claim details, such as transaction date or amount, can render a claim non-duplicate. Employees may not recognize that specific criteria outlined in the clause, such as the same merchant and bill number, are sufficient to classify a claim as an exact duplicate. This clause is conceptually related to the overall expense submission process, as it emphasizes the importance of accuracy and attention to detail when submitting claims. Understanding this relationship helps employees avoid potential rejections and ensures adherence to corporate expense policies.

## DUP-1.2 - Near duplicate

A claim by the same employee at the same merchant within 3 days of an earlier expense, with an amount within 2 percent of it and a different bill number, is a possible duplicate. The reviewer requests clarification from the employee.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the identification of potential duplicate expense claims submitted by the same employee for the same merchant within a short time frame. The purpose is to ensure that the company maintains accurate financial records and prevents the reimbursement of expenses that may not be legitimate. Typical business situations that this clause covers include instances where an employee may inadvertently submit multiple claims for similar expenses, which could arise from frequent business interactions with the same merchant or a misunderstanding of the expense reporting process.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that any expense claim submitted within a short time frame is automatically deemed a duplicate. However, the clause specifies particular conditions, such as the amount being within a defined percentage and the requirement for a different bill number. This concept is closely related to other policies regarding expense approval and verification processes, as it emphasizes the importance of thorough review and clarification to ensure compliance and accuracy in financial reporting.

## DUP-1.3 - Recurring charges

A recurring charge is a repeat at the same merchant by the same employee between 26 and 35 days after an earlier expense whose purpose is recurring, with an amount within 5 percent. It is not a duplicate.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause defines recurring charges and outlines the criteria under which they are recognized. The purpose is to differentiate between genuine recurring expenses and potential duplicates, thereby ensuring that employees are reimbursed for legitimate costs associated with ongoing services or products. Typical business situations include subscriptions, memberships, or other regular payments that an employee may incur while conducting business on behalf of the company, which occur within a specified timeframe after the initial expense.

A common misconception is that any repeated expense is automatically classified as a duplicate, leading to unnecessary scrutiny of legitimate recurring charges. This clause clarifies that such charges are not duplicates if they meet specific criteria, thereby distinguishing them from other expense types. This topic is conceptually linked to the broader expense management policies, particularly those addressing approval processes for repeated expenditures, as it highlights the need for clarity and consistency in expense classification.

## DUP-2.1 - Split transactions

Purchases by the same employee at the same merchant for the same project within 3 days of each other, whose amounts differ by more than 2 percent, are treated together. The combined amount governs the

approval threshold.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the treatment of split transactions, which occur when an employee makes multiple purchases at the same merchant for the same project within a short period. The purpose is to ensure that these transactions are considered collectively for approval purposes, thereby streamlining the expense review process. Common business scenarios include situations where an employee may need to make several purchases to complete a project, necessitating separate transactions that, when combined, may exceed normal approval thresholds.

A frequent misunderstanding is that split transactions are treated as entirely separate claims, which can lead to confusion in the approval process. However, this clause clarifies that such transactions must be evaluated together, reflecting their combined impact on the approval threshold. This concept is closely related to other policies regarding expense approval and reporting, emphasizing the importance of recognizing the cumulative nature of expenses to maintain financial integrity and oversight.

## **DUP-2.2 - Approval for combined spend**

Where the combined amount crosses an approval threshold that each purchase alone did not, an approval of type COMBINED\_SPEND is required. If none exists the reviewer requests it. If an approval exists but of another type, the evidence conflicts and the claim is escalated.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish the requirement for combined spend approval when the total amount of split transactions exceeds a specified approval threshold. This ensures that all expenses, even if submitted separately, are subject to the necessary scrutiny and authorization. Typical situations this clause covers include instances where an employee makes multiple purchases that, when aggregated, necessitate a higher level of approval to ensure compliance with fiscal responsibility and governance standards.

A common misconception is that individual purchases do not require any form of approval if they fall below the threshold, leading to potential oversight of larger combined expenses. This clause clarifies that even if individual amounts are within limits, their aggregation may trigger additional approval requirements. This topic is conceptually linked to the broader expense approval framework, highlighting the importance of comprehensive oversight in ensuring that all expenditures align with corporate policy and budgetary constraints.

# Currency and FX Handling Policy

Document ID D16 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category fx

## FX-1.1 - SGD equivalent

An amount in another currency is converted to SGD using the monthly rate in the FX rate table for the calendar month of the transaction date. The converted amount is not rounded before it is compared with a threshold.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the process for converting expenses incurred in foreign currencies to the local currency for reporting and approval purposes. The purpose is to ensure that all expenses are accurately reflected in the company's financial records in a consistent manner. Typical business scenarios include international travel or purchases made by employees in foreign markets, where transactions may be recorded in various currencies and need to be standardized for effective financial management.

A common misunderstanding is that the conversion process may involve rounding or adjustments before comparing amounts to thresholds, which is not permitted under this clause. The emphasis on using the monthly rate directly for conversions ensures clarity and consistency in financial reporting. This topic is related to other policies concerning currency management and expense reporting, as it underscores the importance of accurate currency conversion in maintaining the integrity of financial data across different regions and currencies.

## FX-1.2 - Which tests use SGD

Approval thresholds expressed in SGD equivalent, software tiers and equipment tiers are tested on the SGD equivalent. Regional ceilings and regional approval thresholds expressed in a local currency are tested in that currency.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause specifies the circumstances under which expenses are tested against approval thresholds, distinguishing between those expressed in the local currency and those converted to the local currency equivalent. The purpose is to provide clarity on how different currencies are treated within the approval framework, ensuring that all expenses are evaluated fairly and consistently. Typical scenarios include regional transactions where local currencies are used, necessitating careful consideration of how these amounts relate to corporate approval processes.

A common misunderstanding is that all expenses should be converted to the local currency for evaluation, regardless of the context, which can lead to confusion. This clause clarifies that certain regional thresholds remain in their original currency, thereby maintaining the integrity of local financial practices. This topic is conceptually linked to other policies regarding currency conversion and expense approval, emphasizing the importance of context in financial decision-making and compliance with corporate governance.

## FX-1.3 - Comparison

A threshold is crossed when the amount is strictly greater than the threshold. An amount equal to the threshold does not cross it.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear criterion for determining when a specified threshold has been crossed in relation to expense amounts. This is particularly relevant in situations where approvals or additional scrutiny are required once certain financial limits are surpassed. It ensures that all employees understand that only amounts exceeding the threshold will trigger any necessary actions, thereby promoting clarity and consistency in expense reporting.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that amounts equal to the threshold may also be considered as having crossed it. This can lead to confusion in reporting and compliance. It is important to note that this concept is closely related to other policy topics such as approval processes and reporting requirements, where precise definitions of thresholds are critical to maintaining financial discipline.

## FX-1.4 - Card-posted amounts

The amount posted on a corporate card statement is not used for threshold tests.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause clarifies that the amounts reflected on corporate card statements are not utilized for the purpose of threshold assessments within the expense reporting framework. It serves to delineate the specific context in which these amounts are considered, ensuring that employees understand that the posted figures do not influence any evaluations related to compliance with expense limits or thresholds. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees may be submitting expenses that

involve corporate card transactions, as it highlights the distinction between recorded amounts and actual expenses incurred.

A common misunderstanding may arise concerning the interpretation of posted amounts as indicators of allowable expenses. Employees might mistakenly believe that the amounts on their corporate card statements should be factored into their overall expense reporting, which is not the case. This clause is conceptually linked to broader policies concerning expense reporting and compliance, as it underscores the importance of accurately categorizing and reporting expenses without relying on potentially misleading figures from card statements.

# Singapore Expense Addendum

Document ID D17 · Region SG · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category regional

## SG-1.1 - Scope and precedence

This addendum applies to transactions incurred in Singapore. Where it differs from a global policy for the same subject, this addendum controls, and a Finance circular that names one of its clauses amends that clause from the effective date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the applicability and precedence of the addendum concerning transactions incurred in Singapore. It is essential for ensuring that employees are aware that in instances where the addendum diverges from global policies, the local guidelines take precedence. This is particularly important in business situations where employees may engage in activities that are subject to both local and global policies, as it provides clarity on which set of rules governs their conduct and expense reporting.

A potential area of confusion may arise when employees encounter discrepancies between the addendum and global policies. Some may assume that global policies are universally applicable, not recognizing the specific authority granted to local guidelines in this context. This clause is conceptually linked to the overarching governance of corporate policies, as it emphasizes the need for localized adaptations while maintaining alignment with global standards, thereby ensuring compliance with local regulations and practices.

## SG-2.1 - Employee meal ceiling

The employee-only meal ceiling per person, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 45            |
| 2025 | 50            |
| 2026 | 55            |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the parameters for meal expenses incurred by employees, specifically addressing the maximum allowable amount per individual. It serves to create a structured framework for managing dining expenses that employees may incur during business-related activities. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees are entertaining clients or attending business meetings that involve meals, as it provides a clear guideline to ensure that expenses remain reasonable and justifiable.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause may involve the assumption that all meal expenses can be claimed without regard for the specified limits. Employees may misinterpret the ceiling as a flexible guideline rather than a definitive boundary. This clause is conceptually related to other policies regarding expense limits and entertainment, as it highlights the importance of fiscal responsibility and adherence to established guidelines in managing corporate resources effectively.

## SG-2.2 - Client meal ceiling

The client meal ceiling per attendee, including employees present, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 120           |
| 2025 | 120           |
| 2026 | 130           |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to define a ceiling for meal expenses incurred when entertaining clients, including employees present at the meal. This is particularly relevant in business contexts where client relationships are fostered through dining experiences. By establishing a clear ceiling, the clause aims to balance the need for effective client engagement with the necessity of managing corporate expenditures.

A common misunderstanding may arise in assuming that the client meal ceiling is the same as the employee meal ceiling, which could lead to inappropriate expense claims. This clause is related to other policies governing entertainment and dining expenses, highlighting the importance of distinguishing between different categories of expenses to ensure that all claims are compliant with corporate policies and financial regulations.

## SG-2.3 - Entertainment ceiling

The entertainment ceiling per external attendee, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 180           |
| 2025 | 190           |
| 2026 | 200           |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause specifies the maximum allowable expense for entertainment purposes, particularly concerning external attendees. The intent is to provide a clear framework for managing costs associated with entertaining clients or stakeholders, ensuring that expenses are kept within a reasonable range. This is critical in business situations where employees are tasked with hosting events or meetings that involve external parties, as it establishes a standard for what constitutes acceptable spending in these contexts.

A potential misunderstanding may arise when employees perceive the entertainment ceiling as a suggestion rather than a firm limit. Some may believe they can exceed this amount if they deem the expense justifiable, which is not in alignment with the policy. This clause is conceptually linked to other expense-related policies, emphasizing the need for accountability and transparency in corporate spending, while also ensuring that entertainment expenses are managed in a manner consistent with the company's financial objectives.

**SG-3.1 - Gift ceiling per gift**

The ceiling for a single gift to one recipient, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 100           |
| 2025 | 120           |
| 2026 | 120           |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear limit on the value of gifts that can be given to a single recipient within a specified timeframe. This is particularly relevant in business contexts where maintaining professional relationships is essential, such as during client meetings, corporate events, or when expressing gratitude to partners. By setting a ceiling on the value of gifts, the company aims to promote ethical practices and prevent any potential conflicts of interest that may arise from excessive gift-giving.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause may arise from the assumption that the ceiling applies uniformly across all situations. However, it is important to recognize that this limit is specific to each individual gift and does not aggregate over time or across multiple gifts to the same recipient. Additionally, this topic is conceptually linked to the annual gift ceiling per recipient organisation, which governs cumulative gifting to the same entity, ensuring that both individual and organisational gifting practices remain within ethical boundaries.

**SG-3.2 - Annual gift ceiling per recipient organisation**

The calendar-year ceiling for gifts to one recipient organisation, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 400           |
| 2025 | 450           |
| 2026 | 450           |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause aims to delineate the maximum allowable value of gifts that can be given to a single recipient organisation throughout the calendar year. It is particularly applicable in scenarios where multiple gifts may be presented to the same organisation, such as during various corporate events, sponsorships, or partnership recognitions. By establishing this ceiling, the company seeks to foster goodwill while ensuring that the total value of gifts remains reasonable and does not compromise the integrity of business relationships.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that it operates independently from the individual gift ceiling. However, it is crucial to understand that both clauses work in tandem to regulate gifting practices, with one focusing on individual gifts and the other on cumulative gifts to organisations. This relationship underscores the importance of maintaining ethical standards across all forms of gifting, aligning with broader policies on corporate hospitality and expenditure.

**SG-4.1 - Mileage rate**

The private vehicle mileage rate per kilometre, in SGD, is:

| Year | Rate (SGD per km) |
|------|-------------------|
| 2024 | 0.6               |
| 2025 | 0.6               |
| 2026 | 0.65              |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to define the reimbursement rate for employees using private vehicles for business purposes. This rate serves to ensure that employees are fairly compensated for the costs incurred while conducting company business, such as attending meetings, site visits, or client engagements. By establishing a clear mileage rate, the company aims to promote transparency and consistency in expense reporting, thereby facilitating smoother financial operations and accountability.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the application of the mileage rate, particularly concerning what constitutes reimbursable travel. Employees might erroneously assume that all travel-related expenses are covered under this rate, when in fact it specifically pertains to the distance driven for business purposes. This clause is conceptually related to other travel-related policies, such as those governing transportation allowances and travel reimbursements, which collectively aim to provide comprehensive guidelines for employee expenses.

**SG-5.1 - Telecom monthly ceiling**

The monthly telecommunications ceiling per employee, in SGD, is:

| Year | Ceiling (SGD) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 80            |
| 2025 | 90            |
| 2026 | 90            |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes a monthly ceiling for telecommunications expenses incurred by employees, ensuring that communication costs remain within reasonable bounds. It is particularly relevant in the context of remote work, client communications, and internal collaboration, where employees may rely heavily on telecommunication services. By setting this ceiling, the company aims to control costs while still enabling employees to maintain effective communication channels necessary for their roles.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the belief that the ceiling applies exclusively to mobile phone expenses. However, it encompasses all telecommunications costs, including landlines and internet services, which may lead to confusion regarding what expenses are eligible for reimbursement. This clause is conceptually linked to other expense policies, such as those governing general office supplies and operational costs, which collectively aim to ensure prudent financial management across all areas of employee expenditures.

**SG-2.4 - Alcohol**

Alcohol is permitted only with external attendees and may not exceed 35 percent of the total bill in 2024 and 2025, and 30 percent in 2026.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to regulate the consumption of alcohol during business-related events, ensuring that it is only provided in the presence of external attendees. This policy is particularly relevant during client dinners, corporate celebrations, or networking events, where the presence of alcohol may enhance social interactions. By limiting the proportion of the total bill that can be attributed to alcohol, the company aims to promote responsible consumption and maintain a professional image.

Common misunderstandings may arise from the perception that the percentage limit applies to all expenses within the event. However, it is essential to recognize that this limit specifically pertains to the alcohol portion of the total bill, not the overall expenditure. This clause is conceptually related to other hospitality policies, such as those governing entertainment and meal expenses, which collectively aim to ensure that corporate hospitality remains appropriate and aligns with the company's values.

**SG-2.5 - Tips**

Service charges are ordinarily included. A voluntary gratuity above the global limit requires manager approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause aims to clarify the treatment of service charges and gratuities in the context of business-related dining expenses. It is particularly relevant during client meetings, business lunches, or corporate events where dining is involved. By stating that service charges are ordinarily included,

the company seeks to simplify the expense reporting process while also providing guidelines for any additional voluntary gratuities that may be warranted based on service quality.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that a voluntary gratuity is always permissible without further consideration. However, it is crucial to note that any gratuity exceeding the global limit requires managerial approval, which serves to maintain oversight and prevent excessive spending. This topic is conceptually linked to other dining-related policies, such as those addressing meal allowances and entertainment expenses, which collectively guide employees in making prudent financial decisions while representing the company.

#### **SG-4.2 - Taxi**

Taxi and ride-hailing within Singapore follow the Ground Transportation Policy.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the framework for the use of taxi and ride-hailing services within Singapore, aligning with the broader Ground Transportation Policy. Its purpose is to ensure that employees utilize approved modes of transportation that adhere to corporate standards while conducting business-related activities. Typical situations covered by this clause may include travel to client meetings, airport transfers, or other work-related events where ground transportation is necessary. By providing clear guidelines, the company aims to promote cost-effectiveness and compliance with local regulations, thereby enhancing operational efficiency during travel.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that all taxi and ride-hailing expenses are automatically reimbursable without consideration of the Ground Transportation Policy. Employees may mistakenly assume that any transportation expense incurred in Singapore is permissible, regardless of the nature of the trip or the choice of service provider. This clause conceptually relates to the broader topics of travel expenses and reimbursement procedures, as it emphasizes the need for adherence to established policies that govern various modes of transportation, ensuring that all travel-related expenses remain within the company's financial framework.

#### **SG-6.1 - Approval thresholds**

The global approval thresholds in SGD equivalent apply without change.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish that the global approval thresholds remain consistent and unchanged in their application, specifically in the context of the Singapore operations. This provision is crucial for maintaining uniformity across the organization, ensuring that all employees understand the limits that govern expense approvals. Typical business situations that this clause addresses include the submission of expense reports and requests for reimbursements that require managerial review and approval, thus facilitating a standardized approach to financial management across different regions.

A common misconception regarding this clause is the assumption that it allows for flexibility or alterations to the approval thresholds based on local circumstances or individual discretion. Employees may incorrectly believe that they can negotiate or bypass these thresholds, leading to potential compliance issues. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies concerning expense management and approval processes, reinforcing the importance of adhering to established financial controls that safeguard the company's resources and ensure accountability in financial transactions.

#### **SG-6.2 - Entertainment approval**

Entertainment requires manager approval where the total exceeds SGD 500.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the requirement for managerial approval for entertainment expenses that exceed a specified threshold. Its primary purpose is to ensure that all entertainment-related expenditures are justified and aligned with the company's objectives and budgetary constraints. Typical situations covered by this clause may include team-building events, client dinners, or other entertainment activities that involve significant costs. By requiring managerial oversight, the company aims to promote responsible spending while fostering a culture of accountability in financial decision-making.

A common misunderstanding related to this clause is the belief that any entertainment expense requires prior approval, regardless of the amount spent. Employees may confuse this requirement with general expense reporting practices, leading to unnecessary delays or complications in the reimbursement process. This clause is conceptually related to the broader topics of expense approvals and financial governance, highlighting the importance of managerial oversight in maintaining fiscal responsibility and ensuring that entertainment expenses are both appropriate and beneficial to the company's interests.

# India Expense Addendum

Document ID D18 · Region IN · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category regional

## IN-1.1 - Scope and precedence

This addendum applies to transactions incurred in India. Where it differs from a global policy for the same subject, this addendum controls, and a Finance circular that names one of its clauses amends that clause from the effective date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This addendum serves to clarify the applicability of certain transactions incurred in India, establishing its precedence over global policies when discrepancies arise. Its purpose is to ensure that employees operating in India adhere to specific guidelines that may differ from the overarching corporate policies, thereby accommodating local regulations and business practices. Typical situations addressed by this clause include expense reporting, compliance with local financial regulations, and any amendments necessitated by the unique operational landscape in India, ensuring that employees remain compliant while conducting business activities.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that it allows for arbitrary deviations from global policies without proper justification. Employees may misinterpret the precedence established by this addendum, leading to potential non-compliance with corporate standards. This clause is conceptually linked to other regional policies and amendments, emphasizing the importance of understanding local contexts while still adhering to the fundamental principles of the company's overall governance framework.

## IN-2.1 - Employee meal ceiling

The employee-only meal ceiling per person, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 1,800         |
| 2025 | 2,000         |
| 2026 | 2,200         |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes a ceiling for employee-only meal expenses incurred in India, providing a clear guideline for permissible spending in this category. Its purpose is to regulate meal expenditures during business-related activities, ensuring that costs remain within reasonable limits while promoting fairness and consistency in reimbursement practices. Typical situations covered by this clause may include business lunches, dinners, or any meal expenses incurred during official travel or meetings, thereby fostering a culture of responsible financial management within the organization.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause is the assumption that the meal ceiling applies uniformly to all meal-related expenses without regard for specific circumstances. Employees may mistakenly believe that they can exceed the established ceiling if they deem the expense necessary, which could lead to potential reimbursement issues. This clause is conceptually related to other expense policies, such as those governing travel and entertainment, highlighting the importance of maintaining clear boundaries for various types of expenditures to ensure compliance and accountability in financial reporting.

## IN-2.2 - Client meal ceiling

The client meal ceiling per attendee, including employees present, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 4,500         |
| 2025 | 4,500         |
| 2026 | 5,000         |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the ceiling for client meal expenses, including those for employees present during the meal, thereby establishing a clear framework for permissible spending in client-related dining situations. Its purpose is to regulate expenditures associated with client entertainment, ensuring that costs remain reasonable while fostering positive business relationships. Typical situations covered by this clause may include client meetings, business negotiations, or networking events where meals are provided, thus promoting a standard approach to client engagement and financial accountability.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the belief that the client meal ceiling applies only to external attendees, neglecting the inclusion of employees present at the meal. Employees may misinterpret the guidelines, leading to potential discrepancies in expense reporting. This clause is conceptually linked to

other policies concerning entertainment and travel expenses, emphasizing the need for clarity and consistency in managing various types of expenditures to uphold the company's financial integrity and compliance.

**IN-2.3 - Entertainment ceiling**

The entertainment ceiling per external attendee, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 6,500         |
| 2025 | 7,000         |
| 2026 | 7,500         |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear limit on the amount that can be spent on entertainment for external attendees during business-related activities. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees are hosting clients, potential clients, or other external stakeholders to foster business relationships through meals, events, or other forms of entertainment. By setting a ceiling, the company aims to maintain fiscal responsibility while allowing employees to engage in necessary social interactions that can lead to business opportunities.

Common misunderstandings regarding this clause may arise from the belief that the ceiling is merely a guideline rather than a firm limit. Employees might mistakenly think that exceeding the specified amount is permissible if justified by the circumstances. This topic is conceptually related to other expense policies, such as those governing gifts and travel, as they all share the underlying principle of ensuring that expenditures are reasonable and justifiable in the context of business operations.

**IN-3.1 - Gift ceiling per gift**

The ceiling for a single gift to one recipient, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 3,500         |
| 2025 | 4,000         |
| 2026 | 4,500         |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to define the maximum allowable expenditure for a single gift to an individual recipient, ensuring that the company maintains appropriate standards in its gifting practices. It is particularly applicable in contexts where employees are required to cultivate business relationships through the provision of gifts, such as during client meetings or as tokens of appreciation. By establishing a ceiling, the company aims to encourage thoughtful gifting while mitigating the risk of excessive spending that could be perceived as inappropriate or extravagant.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the notion that gifts can be aggregated or combined to circumvent the ceiling for a single gift. Employees might believe that providing multiple smaller gifts to a recipient is acceptable if the total value remains within limits. This clause is conceptually linked to the annual gift ceiling per recipient organisation, as both policies aim to regulate the nature and extent of gifting practices to ensure compliance with ethical standards and corporate governance.

**IN-3.2 - Annual gift ceiling per recipient organisation**

The calendar-year ceiling for gifts to one recipient organisation, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 14,000        |
| 2025 | 15,000        |
| 2026 | 16,000        |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to delineate the maximum allowable expenditure for gifts given to a single recipient organisation over the course of a calendar year. This is particularly relevant in scenarios where employees engage with organisations that may influence business relationships, such as clients, partners, or vendors. By establishing an annual ceiling, the company seeks to promote responsible gifting practices while fostering goodwill and maintaining professional integrity in business interactions.

A common misunderstanding may occur when employees assume that the annual ceiling applies to each individual gift rather than the cumulative total for the year. This can lead to confusion regarding how multiple gifts should be accounted for throughout the year. This clause is conceptually related to the ceiling for a single

gift, as both policies work in tandem to ensure that gifting practices remain within acceptable financial and ethical boundaries.

**IN-4.1 - Mileage rate**

The private vehicle mileage rate per kilometre, in INR, is:

| Year | Rate (INR per km) |
|------|-------------------|
| 2024 | 11                |
| 2025 | 12                |
| 2026 | 12                |

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the mileage reimbursement rate for employees using private vehicles for business purposes. It serves to provide clarity on the compensation employees can expect when they incur travel expenses while conducting company-related activities. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees are required to travel for client meetings, site visits, or other business-related engagements that necessitate the use of their personal vehicles.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the belief that employees can claim additional expenses beyond the established mileage rate, such as fuel costs or wear and tear on the vehicle. Employees might think that these factors can be included in their reimbursement claims. This topic is conceptually related to other travel-related policies, such as those governing transportation and accommodation, as they all aim to ensure that employees are fairly compensated for business-related travel without incurring undue financial burden.

**IN-5.1 - Telecom monthly ceiling**

The monthly telecommunications ceiling per employee, in INR, is:

| Year | Ceiling (INR) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 2,500         |
| 2025 | 2,500         |
| 2026 | 3,000         |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to set a limit on the monthly telecommunications expenses that can be reimbursed to employees. This is particularly relevant in the context of ensuring that employees have adequate communication tools to perform their duties effectively while maintaining cost control for the company. Situations covered by this clause include business calls, data usage, and other telecommunications needs that arise during the course of work-related activities.

Common misunderstandings may occur when employees believe that the ceiling is flexible or can be adjusted based on individual circumstances. Some may think that exceeding the ceiling is acceptable if they can justify the additional expense. This clause is conceptually linked to other expense policies, such as those related to travel and entertainment, as they all emphasize the importance of managing costs while providing employees with the necessary resources to fulfill their roles.

**IN-2.4 - Alcohol prohibition**

Alcohol is not reimbursable for transactions in India, including client entertainment, regardless of any approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause is intended to explicitly prohibit the reimbursement of expenses related to alcohol for transactions conducted in India, including client entertainment. The aim is to uphold the company's commitment to responsible business practices and to avoid any potential ethical dilemmas that may arise from the consumption of alcohol in professional settings. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees may be tempted to include alcohol as part of business meals or entertainment events.

A common misunderstanding may arise from the belief that alcohol can be reimbursed if it is part of a larger entertainment budget or if it is deemed necessary for a particular business context. Employees might think that approval from management could allow for exceptions to this prohibition. This clause is conceptually related to other policies regarding entertainment and gifts, as they all serve to establish clear guidelines for acceptable business conduct and expenditure.

**IN-2.5 - Tips**

Voluntary gratuity above 15 percent of the bill requires manager approval.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a framework for the approval of voluntary gratuities that exceed a specified percentage of the bill. It is particularly relevant in business situations where

employees are dining with clients or stakeholders, and where the level of service may warrant a higher gratuity. This clause ensures that such discretionary expenses are monitored and controlled, thereby promoting fiscal responsibility while allowing for flexibility in rewarding exceptional service.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may believe they can automatically provide gratuities above the specified percentage without prior approval. It is essential to recognize that this clause is designed to prevent excessive spending and to ensure that all discretionary expenses align with the company's financial guidelines. This topic is conceptually linked to other expense policies, such as those governing entertainment and hospitality, which also require managerial oversight to maintain consistency and accountability across all employee expenditures.

## **IN-4.2 - Local transport**

App-based taxi is reimbursable for approved business travel; the normal commute is not. Rail follows the class entitlement for the grade.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the conditions under which app-based taxi services are reimbursable for business travel, specifying that such travel must be pre-approved. It is particularly applicable in situations where employees are required to travel for meetings, conferences, or other work-related engagements. Additionally, it clarifies that normal commuting expenses are not eligible for reimbursement, thereby distinguishing between personal and business-related travel expenses.

A common misconception is that all transportation expenses incurred during work hours are automatically reimbursable, which is not the case. Employees should be aware that this clause emphasizes the need for prior approval for business travel, aligning it with the broader framework of travel and transport policies. This topic also intersects with the approval thresholds for expenses, as both require managerial oversight to ensure that expenditures are justified and within the company's financial parameters.

## **IN-6.1 - Approval thresholds**

Manager approval is required for any single discretionary expense above INR 20,000 in local currency, which is stricter than the global SGD threshold and therefore controls. Director and Finance thresholds are the global SGD equivalents.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear threshold for manager approval of discretionary expenses, ensuring that significant expenditures are subject to scrutiny. This is particularly relevant in business scenarios involving large purchases or investments that may impact the company's budget. By requiring managerial approval for expenses above the specified threshold, the company aims to maintain financial discipline and accountability in its spending practices.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may not fully grasp the implications of the specified threshold, assuming that all expenses below it do not require any form of oversight. It is important to recognize that this clause is part of a larger framework of financial controls, which includes entertainment approval and local transport policies. These interconnected policies collectively ensure that all discretionary spending is appropriately managed, fostering a culture of responsible financial stewardship within the organization.

## **IN-6.2 - Entertainment approval**

Entertainment above the regional manager threshold requires manager approval of type ENTERTAINMENT or GENERAL.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause addresses the need for managerial approval for entertainment expenses that exceed a certain threshold, reinforcing the importance of oversight in discretionary spending. It is particularly applicable in business contexts where employees may engage in entertaining clients or partners, and where such activities can significantly impact the company's financial resources. By requiring approval for entertainment expenses, the company aims to ensure that such expenditures are justifiable and aligned with business objectives.

A common misconception is that all entertainment-related expenses are automatically approved without the need for managerial consent, which can lead to misunderstandings regarding fiscal responsibility. This clause is closely related to the approval thresholds for discretionary expenses, as both emphasize the necessity of managerial oversight to prevent excessive spending. Understanding this connection is crucial for employees to navigate the expense policy effectively and ensure compliance with the company's financial guidelines.

## **IN-7.1 - Submission window**

For transactions dated in 2026, a domestic claim must be submitted within 60 calendar days instead of the global window; claims from day 61 up to and including day 75 require manager approval, and claims after day 75 are escalated to Finance.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a specific submission window for domestic claims related to transactions dated in a specified year, thereby ensuring timely processing of expenses. This is particularly relevant in situations where employees may incur costs during business activities, and it emphasizes the importance of adhering to submission timelines to facilitate efficient reimbursement. By defining this window, the company aims to streamline its expense management processes and maintain accurate financial records.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume that the global submission window applies uniformly to all claims, which is not the case for transactions falling under this clause. It is essential to recognize that this submission window is part of a broader framework that includes approval and escalation tiers, which may vary regionally. Understanding these distinctions is crucial for employees to ensure compliance with the company's policies and to avoid delays in the reimbursement process.

# Japan Expense Addendum

Document ID D19 · Region JP · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category regional

## JP-1.1 - Scope and precedence

This addendum applies to transactions incurred in Japan. Where it differs from a global policy for the same subject, this addendum controls, and a Finance circular that names one of its clauses amends that clause from the effective date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this addendum is to clarify the applicability of specific policies to transactions incurred in Japan, establishing precedence over global policies when discrepancies arise. This is particularly relevant in business situations where employees are operating in Japan and may encounter unique regulatory or cultural considerations that necessitate tailored guidelines. By delineating the scope of this addendum, the company aims to provide clear direction for employees and ensure compliance with local practices.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may not fully recognize the implications of this addendum, assuming that global policies apply uniformly without regard for local variations. It is important to understand that this addendum serves to align the company's policies with local laws and customs, thereby enhancing operational effectiveness. This topic is conceptually linked to other regional policies, as both aim to ensure that employees are equipped with the necessary guidance to navigate the complexities of conducting business in diverse environments.

## JP-2.1 - Employee meal ceiling

The employee-only meal ceiling per person, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 4,500         |
| 2025 | 5,000         |
| 2026 | 5,500         |

**Interpretive guidance.** The clause regarding the employee meal ceiling establishes a financial limit for meals consumed by employees during business-related activities. This policy is designed to ensure that expenditures remain reasonable and within the company's budgetary constraints. Typical scenarios covered by this clause include business lunches, team-building events, and other occasions where employees are provided meals as part of their duties. By setting a ceiling, the company aims to promote responsible spending while still allowing employees to enjoy meals that facilitate collaboration and productivity.

A common misunderstanding surrounding the employee meal ceiling is the belief that it applies uniformly to all meal types or settings, when in fact it specifically pertains to meals consumed by employees in a business context. This clause is conceptually linked to other expense policies, such as those governing client meals and entertainment expenses, which have distinct ceilings and purposes. Employees should be aware that exceeding the established ceiling may result in non-reimbursement, emphasizing the importance of adhering to the specified limits.

## JP-2.2 - Client meal ceiling

The client meal ceiling per attendee, including employees present, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 12,000        |
| 2025 | 12,000        |
| 2026 | 13,000        |

**Interpretive guidance.** The clause concerning the client meal ceiling delineates the maximum allowable expenditure for meals involving clients, which includes any employees present during the meal. This policy is essential for maintaining professional relationships while ensuring that the company's resources are allocated judiciously. Typical situations that fall under this clause include client meetings, negotiations, and business development lunches, where the objective is to foster goodwill and strengthen partnerships. By setting a ceiling, the company encourages employees to engage with clients in a manner that is both respectful and fiscally responsible.

A frequent misconception regarding the client meal ceiling is that it applies only to external clients, overlooking the inclusion of employees present at these meals. This clause is interconnected with other

expense policies, such as the employee meal ceiling, which governs meals solely for employees, and the entertainment ceiling, which pertains to expenses incurred for external attendees. Understanding these distinctions is crucial for employees to ensure compliance with the policy and avoid potential reimbursement issues.

**JP-2.3 - Entertainment ceiling**

The entertainment ceiling per external attendee, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 16,000        |
| 2025 | 17,000        |
| 2026 | 18,000        |

**Interpretive guidance.** The entertainment ceiling clause establishes a financial limit for expenses incurred during entertainment activities involving external attendees. This policy is vital for managing the company's budget while facilitating networking and relationship-building opportunities. Typical scenarios covered by this clause include hosting clients at events, conferences, or social gatherings aimed at enhancing business relationships. By defining a ceiling, the company seeks to promote effective and appropriate spending on entertainment while ensuring that such expenditures align with corporate objectives.

A common misunderstanding regarding the entertainment ceiling is the assumption that it applies to all types of entertainment, when it specifically pertains to external attendees. This clause is related to other expense policies, such as the client meal ceiling, which addresses meals that may also involve entertainment aspects. Employees must recognize the importance of adhering to these distinct ceilings to avoid non-reimbursement and to maintain the integrity of the company's expense management practices.

**JP-3.1 - Gift ceiling per gift**

The ceiling for a single gift to one recipient, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 6,000         |
| 2025 | 6,000         |
| 2026 | 7,000         |

**Interpretive guidance.** The clause regarding the gift ceiling per gift sets a limit on the value of a single gift given to an individual recipient. This policy is crucial for ensuring that gift-giving practices remain within acceptable financial boundaries while fostering goodwill and maintaining professional relationships. Typical situations covered by this clause include holiday gifts, thank-you gestures, or tokens of appreciation for clients, partners, or stakeholders. By establishing a ceiling, the company promotes thoughtful gifting that reflects the company's values without compromising its financial integrity.

A common misconception about the gift ceiling per gift is that it allows for flexibility in interpretation, leading some to believe that gifts can exceed the established limit if deemed appropriate. This clause is conceptually linked to the annual gift ceiling per recipient organization, which governs total gifting to a single entity over a calendar year. Employees should be aware of these distinctions to ensure compliance and avoid potential issues with reimbursement or perceived impropriety in gift-giving.

**JP-3.2 - Annual gift ceiling per recipient organisation**

The calendar-year ceiling for gifts to one recipient organisation, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 24,000        |
| 2025 | 26,000        |
| 2026 | 28,000        |

**Interpretive guidance.** The annual gift ceiling per recipient organization establishes a limit on the total value of gifts that can be given to a single organization within a calendar year. This policy is designed to promote ethical business practices while encouraging relationship building and appreciation among corporate partners. Typical situations covered by this clause include multiple occasions of gifting to the same client or partner throughout the year, ensuring that the company's generosity remains within defined financial parameters. By setting this ceiling, the company aims to balance relationship management with fiscal responsibility.

A common misunderstanding regarding the annual gift ceiling is the belief that it applies to individual gifts rather than the cumulative total for a recipient organization. This clause is interconnected with the gift ceiling per gift, which governs the value of individual gifts, and highlights the importance of strategic gifting practices. Employees must understand these nuances to ensure compliance with the policy and to maintain the company's reputation for ethical conduct in its business dealings.

**JP-4.1 - Mileage rate**

The private vehicle mileage rate per kilometre, in JPY, is:

| Year | Rate (JPY per km) |
|------|-------------------|
| 2024 | 35                |
| 2025 | 37                |
| 2026 | 37                |

**Interpretive guidance.** The mileage rate clause specifies the reimbursement rate for employees using their private vehicles for business purposes. This policy is essential for compensating employees fairly for travel-related expenses incurred while conducting company business. Typical situations that fall under this clause include travel to client meetings, off-site training sessions, or other work-related events where personal vehicles are utilized. By establishing a mileage rate, the company ensures that employees are reimbursed in a consistent and equitable manner, reflecting the costs associated with vehicle use.

A common misunderstanding related to the mileage rate is the assumption that it applies to all travel expenses, when it specifically pertains to reimbursement for the use of personal vehicles. This clause is conceptually linked to other travel-related policies, such as those governing transportation expenses or travel allowances, which may cover different modes of transport. Employees should be aware of these distinctions to ensure they are claiming the appropriate reimbursements and adhering to the relevant policies.

**JP-5.1 - Telecom monthly ceiling**

The monthly telecommunications ceiling per employee, in JPY, is:

| Year | Ceiling (JPY) |
|------|---------------|
| 2024 | 9,000         |
| 2025 | 9,000         |
| 2026 | 10,000        |

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of the telecommunications ceiling clause is to establish a clear limit on the monthly telecommunications expenses that can be incurred by each employee. This serves to promote responsible usage of company resources while ensuring that employees have the necessary tools to communicate effectively for business purposes. Typical business situations covered by this clause include employees using mobile phones, internet services, and other telecommunications services necessary for their roles, particularly when working remotely or traveling for business.

A common misunderstanding regarding the telecommunications ceiling is the belief that it encompasses all types of communication expenses without exception. However, it is essential to recognize that this clause specifically addresses monthly limits and does not cover one-time expenses or exceptional circumstances that may require separate consideration. This clause relates conceptually to neighbouring policies such as those governing travel expenses and equipment reimbursements, as they all aim to ensure prudent financial management and resource allocation within the company.

**JP-2.4 - Alcohol**

Alcohol is permitted only as part of a client meal or entertainment and may not exceed 30 percent of the total bill.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause outlines the conditions under which alcohol may be consumed and reimbursed during client meals or entertainment. By permitting alcohol only in these specific contexts, the policy aims to maintain professionalism and ensure that expenditures remain focused on business objectives. Typical situations covered by this clause include business dinners, client meetings, and networking events where the presence of alcohol may enhance the overall experience and foster relationships.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may assume alcohol can be freely included in any business-related expense. However, the policy explicitly limits alcohol to client meals or entertainment, which helps to prevent misuse and ensures that expenditures are justifiable. This clause is conceptually linked to policies on

entertainment expenses and meal allowances, as both aim to establish guidelines for appropriate spending while reinforcing the company's commitment to responsible financial practices.

### **JP-2.5 - Tips**

Gratuities are not customary and are not reimbursable.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of the tips clause is to clarify the company's position on gratuities, indicating that they are not customary in the context of business expenses and therefore not reimbursable. This policy is intended to streamline the expense reporting process and ensure consistency in how expenses are managed across the organization. Typical situations affected by this clause include meals or services where employees might traditionally consider tipping, such as restaurants or service providers during business travel.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may believe that tips are acceptable if they are deemed small or customary in specific cultures. However, the policy firmly states that gratuities are not reimbursable, which helps to maintain a clear and uniform approach to expense management. This clause relates to other policies regarding meal and entertainment expenses, as all these areas are governed by the overarching principle of ensuring that expenditures are necessary and justifiable in the context of business activities.

### **JP-4.2 - Rail**

Shinkansen ordinary reserved seating is reimbursable for approved business travel. Green Car requires grade G6 or above or a documented exception.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes the reimbursement policy for Shinkansen ordinary reserved seating for approved business travel, ensuring that employees can travel efficiently while adhering to company guidelines. By specifying that Green Car seating requires a higher grade or a documented exception, the policy aims to encourage cost-effective travel decisions while still accommodating necessary comfort levels for employees during business trips. Typical situations covered include travel for client meetings, conferences, or inter-office visits.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the types of seating that are eligible for reimbursement. Employees might assume that any seating class on the Shinkansen is reimbursable, but the policy clearly distinguishes between ordinary reserved seating and Green Car options. This clause connects to broader travel policies, emphasizing the importance of pre-approval for travel-related expenses and the need for employees to align their travel choices with company-approved guidelines.

### **JP-6.1 - Approval thresholds**

Manager approval is required for any single discretionary expense above JPY 45,000 for transactions dated in 2024 and 2025 and above JPY 50,000 for 2026, in local currency, which is stricter than the global SGD threshold and therefore controls.

**Interpretive guidance.** The approval thresholds clause serves to establish a framework for financial oversight by requiring managerial approval for discretionary expenses that exceed specified amounts. This is designed to promote accountability and ensure that higher-value expenditures are justified and aligned with company objectives. Typical business situations this clause covers include employee requests for reimbursement of significant expenses related to travel, entertainment, or other business activities that may impact the company's budget.

A common misunderstanding is that employees may overlook the importance of obtaining the necessary approvals, believing that their expenses will automatically be reimbursed. However, the policy emphasizes the need for prior approval to maintain financial control and transparency. This clause is conceptually related to other approval processes within the company, such as those for project budgets or capital expenditures, reinforcing the overall framework of financial governance and responsible spending practices.

### **JP-6.2 - Country-manager approval**

Entertainment above JPY 60,000 in total requires country-manager approval even when the per-attendee amount is within the ceiling. The approval is recorded as an approval of type ENTERTAINMENT at approver level DIRECTOR.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause stipulates that entertainment expenses exceeding a specific total require country-manager approval, even if the per-attendee amount falls within the established ceiling. The purpose of this requirement is to ensure that larger entertainment expenditures are scrutinized and justified at a higher level, thereby promoting accountability and strategic alignment with company objectives. Typical

situations covered include large-scale client events, corporate functions, or team-building activities that involve significant costs.

A common misunderstanding may arise when employees assume that meeting the per-attendee ceiling is sufficient for reimbursement without considering the total expense. This can lead to confusion regarding the necessity of obtaining additional approval for larger gatherings. This clause is related to other expense approval policies, as they all aim to establish clear parameters for financial oversight and ensure that spending aligns with the company's strategic goals.

### **JP-8.1 - Hotel cities**

Tokyo uses the Tokyo tier. Osaka, Nagoya and Yokohama use the major-city tier. Other Japanese cities use the other-city tier.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause delineates the categorization of hotel cities in Japan, establishing a tiered structure for accommodation expenses based on the city of stay. It serves to streamline expense reporting and reimbursement processes by providing clear guidelines on which tier applies to specific cities, thereby facilitating consistent application across the organization. Typical business situations this clause covers include travel for client meetings, conferences, and other work-related events where hotel accommodations are necessary in various Japanese cities.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the applicability of the tier system to cities not explicitly mentioned in the clause. Employees might assume that any city in Japan falls under the major-city tier, leading to potential discrepancies in expense claims. This clause is conceptually related to other policies regarding travel expenses, as it directly influences the overall travel budget and expense management, ensuring that employees are aware of the financial parameters associated with their travel arrangements.

# Finance Circulars 2024 to 2026

Document ID D20 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category circular

## **CIRC-24-07 - Conference partner-hotel amendment**

Effective 2024-07-01. For approved conferences from 1 July 2024 the partner-hotel uplift applies even when the trip request was approved before the conference registry entry was created.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to clarify the application of the partner-hotel uplift for approved conferences, ensuring that employees are aware of the benefits associated with designated partner hotels. This provision aims to enhance the experience of attendees by promoting specific hotels that offer favorable terms and conditions for corporate events. Typical business situations this clause addresses include conference planning and travel arrangements where employees may seek accommodations aligned with the partner-hotel program.

A common misunderstanding might involve the assumption that prior approvals for travel negate the applicability of the uplift. Employees may believe that the timing of their trip request is the sole determinant of eligibility for the uplift, rather than the conference registry entry. This clause is conceptually linked to broader policies on travel and accommodation, reinforcing the importance of aligning travel choices with organizational partnerships and optimizing expense management through strategic hotel selections.

## **CIRC-25-03 - Finance system outage relief**

Effective 2025-03-01. For transactions dated 10 March 2025 to 14 March 2025 inclusive, formally recorded system outage relief applies: the Finance-escalation tier for late submission is replaced by the manager-approval tier.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause provides a framework for relief during a documented finance system outage, specifically addressing late submissions of expense claims that occur within a defined timeframe. The intent is to alleviate the administrative burden on employees who may be affected by system issues, thereby promoting fairness in the expense reporting process. Typical business situations this clause covers include instances where employees are unable to submit expenses on time due to technical difficulties, ensuring that they are not penalized for circumstances beyond their control.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the specific dates and conditions under which the relief applies, leading employees to believe that it is a blanket policy for all late submissions. It is crucial to recognize that this clause is time-sensitive and directly tied to the documented outage. This policy interacts with other financial policies, particularly those governing expense submission deadlines and approval processes, ensuring that employees understand the implications of system reliability on their expense reporting responsibilities.

## **CIRC-25-04 - Premium economy threshold revision**

Effective 2025-04-01. With effect from 2025-04-01, the amount in the schedule for all rows is replaced by 5.5 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to revise the threshold for premium economy travel, reflecting changes in travel standards and expectations. This policy aims to ensure that employees are provided with appropriate travel accommodations that align with current market conditions and organizational values regarding employee comfort during business travel. Typical business situations this clause addresses include travel for long-distance assignments, client meetings, or conferences where premium economy may be deemed necessary for employee well-being.

A common misunderstanding may involve the assumption that the revised threshold applies retroactively to all transactions, leading to confusion among employees regarding their travel arrangements prior to the effective date. It is essential for employees to recognize that earlier transactions are governed by the previous threshold. This clause is conceptually related to other travel policies, particularly those addressing travel class and accommodation standards, emphasizing the organization's commitment to maintaining a balance between cost-effectiveness and employee comfort.

## **CIRC-25-06 - Tokyo accommodation uplift**

Effective 2025-07-01. With effect from 2025-07-01, the hotel amounts for JP-TOKYO in the schedule for 2025 are increased by 5 percent, rounded half up to the nearest 100. The increase applies to every grade band and

to transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause establishes an uplift for hotel amounts in Tokyo, reflecting the city's unique market conditions and the need for competitive accommodation rates. The intent is to ensure that employees traveling to Tokyo have access to adequate funding for their lodging expenses, thereby supporting their overall travel experience. Typical business situations this clause addresses include corporate travel for meetings, conferences, or events that necessitate overnight stays in Tokyo, ensuring that employees are not financially burdened by the cost of accommodations in a major metropolitan area.

A common misunderstanding may arise regarding the applicability of the uplift to transactions outside of the specified timeframe, leading employees to believe they can claim the increased amounts regardless of their travel dates. It is crucial for employees to understand that the uplift is strictly tied to specific transactions occurring on or after the effective date. This clause relates to other accommodation policies, particularly those governing tiered hotel rates, reinforcing the organization's approach to managing travel expenses while ensuring employee comfort in high-cost areas.

### **CIRC-25-07 - Singapore client meal ceiling revision**

Effective 2025-07-01. With effect from 2025-07-01, the amount in the schedule for SG is replaced by 128 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to revise the ceiling for client meal expenses in Singapore, reflecting changes in market conditions and the organization's commitment to maintaining appropriate standards for client engagement. This policy aims to ensure that employees have adequate resources for dining expenses while entertaining clients, thereby enhancing the quality of business interactions. Typical business situations this clause covers include client meetings, business lunches, and dinners where expenses may be incurred in the course of fostering business relationships.

A common misunderstanding may involve the assumption that the revised ceiling applies to all meal expenses, rather than specifically those incurred in the context of client engagements. Employees must recognize that this clause is designed to support business development activities and should not be interpreted as a general increase in meal allowances. This policy is conceptually linked to broader expense management policies, particularly those governing entertainment and client engagement expenditures, emphasizing the need for strategic spending that aligns with organizational objectives.

### **CIRC-25-09 - Singapore employee meal ceiling revision**

Effective 2025-09-01. With effect from 2025-09-01, the amount in the schedule for SG is replaced by 52 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to update the meal expense ceiling for employees based in Singapore, ensuring that the policy remains relevant and aligned with current market conditions. The revision is particularly pertinent for employees who frequently engage in business activities that involve dining expenses, such as client meetings, team lunches, and other professional gatherings. By establishing a clear ceiling, the company aims to facilitate budgeting and financial planning, while also promoting responsible spending practices among employees.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause may arise from the assumption that the revised ceiling applies retroactively to all transactions. In reality, only transactions occurring on or after the specified effective date will be subject to the new limit, while earlier transactions will adhere to the previously established values. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies on expense reimbursements and meal allowances, as it emphasizes the importance of adhering to set guidelines in order to maintain fiscal responsibility.

### **CIRC-25-10 - Japan employee meal ceiling revision**

Effective 2025-10-01. With effect from 2025-10-01, the amount in the schedule for JP is replaced by 5200 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to revise the meal expense ceiling for employees operating in Japan, thereby reflecting the evolving economic landscape and ensuring that the policy remains applicable to current business practices. This adjustment is particularly relevant for employees who partake in business-related meals, such as entertaining clients or conducting team-building activities over meals. By

clearly defining the new ceiling, the company seeks to streamline expense reporting and enhance financial transparency.

A frequent misconception related to this clause is the belief that all meal expenses incurred after the effective date will automatically be reimbursed at the new ceiling rate. However, it is crucial to understand that only transactions dated on or after the effective date will be governed by this revision, while prior transactions will follow the previous ceiling. This clause is closely related to other expense policies, particularly those concerning client entertainment and employee meal allowances, as it underscores the necessity of adhering to established financial guidelines.

### **CIRC-25-11 - India employee meal ceiling revision**

Effective 2025-11-01. With effect from 2025-11-01, the amount in the schedule for IN is replaced by 2100 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2025. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause is designed to update the meal expense ceiling for employees in India, ensuring that the policy reflects current economic conditions and supports responsible financial practices. It is particularly relevant for employees engaged in business activities that involve meal expenses, such as client engagements and team lunches. By establishing a clear ceiling, the company aims to facilitate expense management and promote accountability among employees when incurring meal-related costs.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause is the assumption that the new ceiling applies to all meal expenses without regard to the transaction date. It is important to clarify that only transactions dated on or after the effective date will fall under the revised ceiling, while earlier transactions will continue to adhere to the previously published values. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies on meal allowances and expense reimbursements, highlighting the importance of compliance with financial guidelines to ensure responsible spending.

### **CIRC-26-02 - Software approval circular**

Effective 2026-02-01. Software subscriptions above SGD 1000 equivalent require both manager approval and an active project record with an open cost centre, from 1 February 2026.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to establish a clear framework for the approval process of software subscriptions that exceed a specified financial threshold. This policy is particularly relevant for departments requiring software solutions to enhance productivity, project management, or operational efficiency. By mandating both managerial approval and the existence of an active project record, the company aims to ensure that software expenditures are justified and aligned with organizational objectives, thereby promoting fiscal responsibility.

A common misconception surrounding this clause is the belief that all software subscriptions require managerial approval, regardless of their cost. In fact, only those subscriptions that exceed the specified threshold necessitate this additional layer of oversight. This clause is conceptually related to other procurement policies, as it emphasizes the importance of financial oversight and accountability in the acquisition of resources, ensuring that expenditures are both necessary and beneficial to the company.

### **CIRC-26-04 - India Tier-1 accommodation uplift**

Effective 2026-04-01. With effect from 2026-04-01, the hotel amounts for IN-T1 in the schedule for 2026 are increased by 6 percent, rounded half up to the nearest 100. The increase applies to every grade band and to transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2026.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to provide clarity regarding the adjustments made to accommodation expenses for Tier-1 hotels in India, ensuring that employees are aware of the updated hotel amounts that will be applicable starting from the specified effective date. This clause is particularly relevant in business situations where employees are required to travel for work and need to secure lodging accommodations that align with corporate expense policies. By establishing a clear increase in hotel amounts, the policy aims to facilitate smoother travel arrangements and ensure that employees are adequately reimbursed for their lodging expenses during business trips.

Common misunderstandings may arise regarding the timing and applicability of the increased hotel amounts. Employees might mistakenly believe that the uplift applies to all past transactions or that it is applicable to other tiers or locations not specified in this clause. It is essential to recognize that this policy is specifically tailored to Tier-1 accommodations in India and is effective only for transactions occurring on or after the stated date. This topic is conceptually linked to neighboring policy areas such as travel allowances and per

diem rates, which also aim to standardize and clarify expense reimbursements for employees on business travel.

**CIRC-26-05 - Japan client meal ceiling revision**

Effective 2026-05-01. With effect from 2026-05-01, the amount in the schedule for JP is replaced by 13500 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2026. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** The purpose of this clause is to revise the meal expense ceiling for client-related meals in Japan, ensuring that the policy reflects current market conditions and supports effective client engagement strategies. This adjustment is particularly significant for employees involved in client entertainment, as it establishes a clear financial guideline for meal expenses incurred during business meetings. By defining the new ceiling, the company aims to promote responsible spending while fostering positive client relationships.

A common misunderstanding regarding this clause may arise from the belief that the revised ceiling applies to all meal expenses without regard to the nature of the transaction. In reality, only client-related meals incurred on or after the effective date will be subject to the new limit, while previous transactions will adhere to earlier established values. This clause is conceptually linked to other policies governing meal allowances and client entertainment expenses, highlighting the importance of compliance with financial guidelines to ensure responsible fiscal practices.

**CIRC-26-06 - Singapore gift ceiling revision**

Effective 2026-06-01. With effect from 2026-06-01, the amount in the schedule for SG is replaced by 130 for transactions dated on or after the effective date and within 2026. Earlier transactions remain governed by the value published for their date.

**Interpretive guidance.** This clause serves to update the parameters governing the acceptance of gifts within the Singapore jurisdiction, ensuring that all transactions occurring on or after the specified effective date adhere to the newly established ceiling. The purpose is to maintain compliance with local regulations and corporate governance standards while fostering ethical business practices. This clause is particularly relevant in scenarios involving client relations, employee recognition, and promotional activities where gifts may be exchanged, thereby necessitating clear guidelines to avoid potential conflicts of interest or ethical breaches.

A common misunderstanding surrounding this clause may arise from the perception that it applies retroactively to transactions prior to the effective date. In reality, earlier transactions are governed by the previously published values, thereby maintaining consistency and clarity in the application of policy. This topic is conceptually linked to other policies concerning corporate gifts, including those that address hospitality and entertainment expenses. Understanding the interplay between these policies is crucial for ensuring comprehensive compliance and ethical conduct in all business dealings.

**CIRC-REG - Circular register**

The circulars in force and the clauses they amend:

| Circular   | Effective  | Subject                                  |
|------------|------------|------------------------------------------|
| CIRC-24-07 | 2024-07-01 | Conference partner-hotel amendment       |
| CIRC-25-03 | 2025-03-01 | Finance system outage relief             |
| CIRC-25-04 | 2025-04-01 | Premium economy threshold revision       |
| CIRC-25-06 | 2025-07-01 | Tokyo accommodation uplift               |
| CIRC-25-07 | 2025-07-01 | Singapore client meal ceiling revision   |
| CIRC-25-09 | 2025-09-01 | Singapore employee meal ceiling revision |
| CIRC-25-10 | 2025-10-01 | Japan employee meal ceiling revision     |
| CIRC-25-11 | 2025-11-01 | India employee meal ceiling revision     |
| CIRC-26-02 | 2026-02-01 | Software approval circular               |
| CIRC-26-04 | 2026-04-01 | India Tier-1 accommodation uplift        |
| CIRC-26-05 | 2026-05-01 | Japan client meal ceiling revision       |
| CIRC-26-06 | 2026-06-01 | Singapore gift ceiling revision          |

**Interpretive guidance.** The circular register serves as a comprehensive record of all circulars currently in force, along with the specific clauses they amend. This clause is essential for maintaining transparency and accessibility of information regarding policy changes, enabling employees to stay informed about the latest

updates that may impact their expense reporting and compliance obligations. The register is particularly useful for employees who need to reference the amendments when preparing expense claims or engaging in financial planning, ensuring that they adhere to the most current guidelines.

A frequent misconception about the circular register is that it only lists new policies, neglecting to highlight amendments to existing ones. In fact, the register encompasses both new circulars and revisions to existing clauses, providing a holistic view of the policy landscape. This topic is closely related to the broader framework of corporate governance, as it underscores the importance of timely communication and documentation in fostering a culture of compliance and accountability within the organization.

# Historical Limits and Superseded Schedules

Document ID D21 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category historical

## HIST-1.1 - Published base schedules: meals

Base values as originally published, before any circular. Later circulars supersede these values from their effective dates.

Employee meal ceiling SG: 2024: 45, 2025: 50, 2026: 55  
Employee meal ceiling IN: 2024: 1,800, 2025: 2,000, 2026: 2,200  
Employee meal ceiling JP: 2024: 4,500, 2025: 5,000, 2026: 5,500  
Client meal ceiling SG: 2024: 120, 2025: 120, 2026: 130  
Client meal ceiling IN: 2024: 4,500, 2025: 4,500, 2026: 5,000  
Client meal ceiling JP: 2024: 12,000, 2025: 12,000, 2026: 13,000  
Entertainment ceiling SG: 2024: 180, 2025: 190, 2026: 200  
Entertainment ceiling IN: 2024: 6,500, 2025: 7,000, 2026: 7,500  
Entertainment ceiling JP: 2024: 16,000, 2025: 17,000, 2026: 18,000

## HIST-1.2 - Published base schedules: gifts, telecom and mileage

Base values as originally published, before any circular.

Gift ceiling SG: 2024: 100, 2025: 120, 2026: 120  
Gift ceiling IN: 2024: 3,500, 2025: 4,000, 2026: 4,500  
Gift ceiling JP: 2024: 6,000, 2025: 6,000, 2026: 7,000  
Annual gift ceiling SG: 2024: 400, 2025: 450, 2026: 450  
Annual gift ceiling IN: 2024: 14,000, 2025: 15,000, 2026: 16,000  
Annual gift ceiling JP: 2024: 24,000, 2025: 26,000, 2026: 28,000  
Telecom monthly ceiling SG: 2024: 80, 2025: 90, 2026: 90  
Telecom monthly ceiling IN: 2024: 2,500, 2025: 2,500, 2026: 3,000  
Telecom monthly ceiling JP: 2024: 9,000, 2025: 9,000, 2026: 10,000  
Mileage rate SG: 2024: 0.6, 2025: 0.6, 2026: 0.65  
Mileage rate IN: 2024: 11, 2025: 12, 2026: 12  
Mileage rate JP: 2024: 35, 2025: 37, 2026: 37

## HIST-1.3 - Published base schedules: hotels

Base nightly values by year, before any circular.

SG-CENTRAL G1-G3: 2024: 280, 2025: 300, 2026: 320  
SG-CENTRAL G4-G5: 2024: 330, 2025: 350, 2026: 370  
SG-CENTRAL G6-G7: 2024: 390, 2025: 410, 2026: 430  
SG-CENTRAL G8+: 2024: 480, 2025: 500, 2026: 520  
IN-T1 G1-G3: 2024: 9,000, 2025: 10,000, 2026: 11,000  
IN-T1 G4-G5: 2024: 12,000, 2025: 13,000, 2026: 14,500  
IN-T1 G6-G7: 2024: 16,000, 2025: 17,000, 2026: 18,500  
IN-T1 G8+: 2024: 21,000, 2025: 22,000, 2026: 24,000  
IN-T2 G1-G3: 2024: 6,000, 2025: 6,500, 2026: 7,000  
IN-T2 G4-G5: 2024: 8,500, 2025: 9,000, 2026: 9,800  
IN-T2 G6-G7: 2024: 11,000, 2025: 11,800, 2026: 12,800  
IN-T2 G8+: 2024: 15,000, 2025: 16,000, 2026: 17,500  
JP-TOKYO G1-G3: 2024: 28,000, 2025: 30,000, 2026: 32,000  
JP-TOKYO G4-G5: 2024: 32,000, 2025: 34,000, 2026: 36,000  
JP-TOKYO G6-G7: 2024: 38,000, 2025: 40,000, 2026: 42,000  
JP-TOKYO G8+: 2024: 46,000, 2025: 49,000, 2026: 52,000  
JP-MAJOR G1-G3: 2024: 24,000, 2025: 25,500, 2026: 27,500

JP-MAJOR G4-G5: 2024: 28,000, 2025: 29,500, 2026: 31,500  
JP-MAJOR G6-G7: 2024: 34,000, 2025: 35,500, 2026: 37,500  
JP-MAJOR G8+: 2024: 41,000, 2025: 43,000, 2026: 46,000  
JP-OTHER G1-G3: 2024: 20,000, 2025: 21,500, 2026: 23,000  
JP-OTHER G4-G5: 2024: 24,000, 2025: 25,500, 2026: 27,000  
JP-OTHER G6-G7: 2024: 29,000, 2025: 30,500, 2026: 32,500  
JP-OTHER G8+: 2024: 35,000, 2025: 37,000, 2026: 39,500

### **HIST-2.1 - Legacy schedule 2023 (expired)**

For information only: the 2023 schedule expired on 31 December 2023 and does not apply to any transaction dated in 2024, 2025 or 2026. Singapore employee meal ceiling per person: SGD 42. Singapore client meal ceiling per attendee: SGD 110. Japan employee meal ceiling per person: JPY 4,200. India employee meal ceiling per person: INR 1,600. Tokyo nightly ceiling for grade band G4-G5: JPY 30,000. Singapore nightly ceiling for grade band G4-G5: SGD 310. Manager approval threshold: SGD 400 equivalent.

### **HIST-2.2 - Superseded 2024 drafts**

A draft of the 2025 policy proposed a forty-day submission window and a director threshold of SGD 1,200. The draft was withdrawn and never took effect. It is retained for audit only.

### **HIST-3.1 - Use of this document**

Values in this document are for locating the base value that applied on a transaction date. They never override a circular that amends them from its effective date.

# Definitions, Frequently Asked Questions and Worked Examples

Document ID D22 · Region GLOBAL · Effective 2024-01-01 to 2099-12-31 · Category faq

## DEF-1.1 - Calendar day

Deadlines are counted in calendar days including weekends and public holidays, from the transaction date to the submission date.

## DEF-1.2 - External attendee

A person who is not an employee of the company or its subsidiaries.

## DEF-1.3 - Approver level

The seniority of an approver: MANAGER, DIRECTOR or FINANCE, in ascending order.

## DEF-1.4 - Cost centre and project

A cost centre is a budget holder. A project is a work order charged to a cost centre, optionally under a parent project.

## DEF-1.5 - Grade band

Grades are grouped into bands used in ceiling tables.

## DEF-1.6 - Nightly rate

The total accommodation charge divided by the number of nights.

## FAQ-1.1 - Question 1

Q: Who decides when two policies appear to conflict?

A: The order of precedence in the global policy decides. Where precedence cannot be determined from published text the claim goes to Finance.

## FAQ-1.2 - Question 2

Q: Does an employee explanation ever replace a system record?

A: No. Where an authoritative record exists it controls. The explanation is used to understand the purpose of the expense.

## FAQ-1.3 - Question 3

Q: What is a discretionary expense?

A: An expense the employee chose to incur within business purpose, as opposed to a mandatory statutory charge or a cost fixed by contract.

## FAQ-1.4 - Question 4

Q: Are taxes included in the amount tested against a ceiling?

A: The total on the bill, including taxes and mandatory service charges, is tested, unless the category policy says the nightly rate or the pre-tip bill is used.

## FAQ-1.5 - Question 5

Q: Can a claim be partly approved?

A: A claim receives one disposition. Where the business portion cannot be separated, or the claim exceeds a computed amount, the claim is returned or rejected as the category policy states.

## FAQ-1.6 - Question 6

Q: What happens when a cited exception cannot be found?

A: The reviewer requests the correct reference from the employee.

## FAQ-1.7 - Question 7

Q: Is a manager approval given after the expense valid?

A: Approval validity is tested against the transaction date and the approval status, as the approval policy sets out.

### **FAQ-1.8 - Question 8**

Q: Can a manager delegate approval while travelling?

A: Yes, through a recorded delegation with a validity period and a limit, as the approval policy describes.

### **FAQ-1.9 - Question 9**

Q: How are recurring charges treated?

A: A repeat that follows the normal interval and the same purpose is not a duplicate; the controls policy sets the interval.

### **FAQ-1.10 - Question 10**

Q: Do regional addenda apply to an employee based in one country who spends in another?

A: The addendum of the country where the expense was incurred applies.

### **FAQ-1.11 - Question 11**

Q: Which document is authoritative for grade?

A: The employee profile record, not the claim.

### **FAQ-1.12 - Question 12**

Q: Are tips reimbursable in every country?

A: The meals policy and the regional addendum decide. In some countries gratuities are not customary.

### **FAQ-1.13 - Question 13**

Q: What is the difference between a gift and hospitality?

A: A gift is given to keep; hospitality is a shared event such as a meal.

### **FAQ-1.14 - Question 14**

Q: Can a project charge to another project's budget?

A: A child project charges the cost centre of its parent project, as the budget policy describes.

### **FAQ-1.15 - Question 15**

Q: Where do I find a superseded value?

A: The historical schedules list the base values by year; circulars supersede them from their effective dates.

### **FAQ-EX-1 - Worked example 1: Tokyo hotel for grade G4**

Prepared January 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A grade G4 employee stays 3 nights in Tokyo in 2025 and is billed JPY 102,000 in total. The nightly rate is JPY 34,000, which equals the 2025 ceiling of JPY 34,000 for the band G4-G5, so the hotel is within the ceiling.

### **FAQ-EX-2 - Worked example 2: Singapore client dinner**

Prepared February 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. Four people, of whom two are external, dine in Singapore in 2025 and are billed SGD 470. Spend per attendee is SGD 117.50 against a ceiling of SGD 120, so the meal is within the ceiling.

### **FAQ-EX-3 - Worked example 3: India employee meal**

Prepared March 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. Three employees in India share a meal costing INR 6,300 in 2025. Spend per person is INR 2,100 against a ceiling of INR 2,000. The meal is above the ceiling.

### **FAQ-EX-4 - Worked example 4: Japan client meal**

Prepared January 2026. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. Five people dine in Japan in 2026 and are billed JPY 64,000. Spend per attendee is JPY 12,800 against a ceiling of JPY 13,000. The meal is within the ceiling.

### **FAQ-EX-5 - Worked example 5: Singapore gift**

Prepared January 2026. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A single gift worth SGD 118 is bought for a client contact in Singapore in 2026. The per-gift ceiling is SGD 120, so the gift is within the ceiling.

#### **FAQ-EX-6 - Worked example 6: Bengaluru hotel**

Prepared February 2026. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A grade G6 employee in Bengaluru in 2026 pays INR 18,400 per night. The 2026 ceiling for the band G6-G7 in the Tier-1 row is INR 18,500. The hotel is within the ceiling.

#### **FAQ-EX-7 - Worked example 7: Late submission**

Prepared December 2024. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A claim for a transaction on 3 December 2024 is submitted on 20 January 2025. The claim is 48 days old. Under the 2024 policy the window is 60 days, so the claim is on time.

#### **FAQ-EX-8 - Worked example 8: Late submission in 2025**

Prepared May 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A claim for a transaction on 1 April 2025 is submitted on 25 June 2025. The claim is 85 days old and falls in the manager-approval tier.

#### **FAQ-EX-9 - Worked example 9: Conference uplift**

Prepared June 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A registered attendee stays at the official partner hotel in Osaka in 2025. The base ceiling for the band G4-G5 is JPY 29,500; with the 2025 uplift of 20 percent the ceiling is JPY 35,400.

#### **FAQ-EX-10 - Worked example 10: Approval threshold and FX**

Prepared April 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. An expense of INR 30,000 is incurred in India in a month when one INR is worth 0.0160 SGD. The SGD equivalent is SGD 480, which is below the global manager threshold, so no approval is required under the global policy.

#### **FAQ-EX-11 - Worked example 11: Software subscription**

Prepared August 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A subscription of SGD 640 for a design tool requires manager approval under the software policy.

#### **FAQ-EX-12 - Worked example 12: Split purchase**

Prepared November 2024. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. Two purchases of SGD 260 and SGD 250 at the same merchant on the same day for the same project total SGD 510. The combined amount is above the manager threshold.

#### **FAQ-EX-13 - Worked example 13: Telecom**

Prepared September 2025. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. An employee in Japan claims JPY 6,000 for mobile data in a month in which JPY 4,500 has already been reimbursed. The total is JPY 10,500.

#### **FAQ-EX-14 - Worked example 14: Training ceiling**

Prepared February 2026. Non-binding illustration; figures reflect the schedule at the time of writing and a later circular may have changed them. A grade G5 employee has been reimbursed SGD 3,000 of external training in 2026 and claims a further SGD 900. The cumulative total is SGD 3,900.